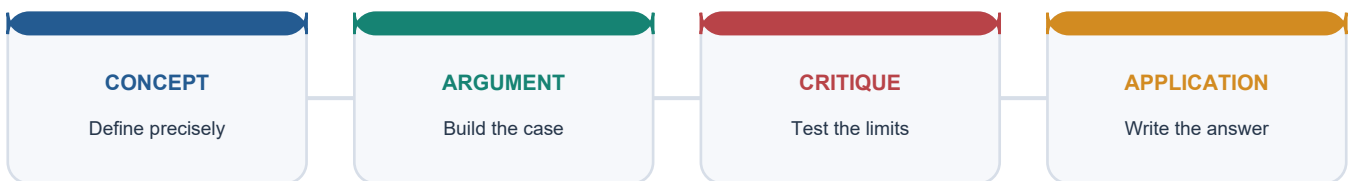


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Making of the Constitution - Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM 57

Making of the Constitution - Complete Learning Session

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

Source audit and scope

- Source order: canonical Basic owner -> optional Advanced owner -> complete topic package -> official syllabus/answer-worthiness/PYQ ledgers -> two local OCR-searchable Laxmikanth texts -> official Sansad/PIB/constitutional text for disputed counts and final provisions.
- Core coverage: demand, Cabinet Mission design, election and representation, Partition change, first meeting, Objectives Resolution, sovereignty, committees, drafting roles, readings, adoption, signing, commencement, functions, symbols, criticism, legitimacy and interpretive use of debates.
- Practice control: exactly 32 original MCQs before four reproduced objective PYQs; strict ABCD rotation eight times; six original Mains answers; no direct owned Mains PYQ was found.
- Evidence control: official first-session material records 207 present, while an older local textbook prints 211; Sansad and the local textbook differ by one day in the elapsed-duration shorthand. Both differences are disclosed rather than harmonised silently.

Progressive roadmap

FOUNDATION	Sessions 1-5 -> demand, design, composition, officers, values
CORE	Sessions 6-12 -> sovereignty, committees, roles, readings, functions, debates, adaptation
SYNTHESIS	Sessions 13-19 -> consensus, plural voices, criticism, metrics, continuity, answers and interpretation
PRACTICE	-> 32 MCQs, four routed Prelims PYQs, six original Mains answers
OPTIONAL ADVANCED	-> enrichment after the answer-complete core
REGISTER NOTES	-> final complete revision spine

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - INTELLECTUAL AND POLITICAL ORIGINS: 1934-1946

Visual first

ROY 1934 -> CONGRESS 1935 -> NEHRU 1938 -> AUGUST OFFER 1940 -> CRIPPS 1942 -> CABINET MISSION 1946

Caption: The demand evolved from Roy's 1934 proposal through Congress's 1935 demand and Nehru's 1938 adult-franchise formulation to the Cabinet Mission's 1946 scheme.

Concept

Constituent authority means the claimed power of a people, acting through a specially constituted body, to create their fundamental constitutional order.

Answer-grabbing line

India's constitution-making demand converted freedom from foreign rule into a claim that the source and procedure of the supreme law must also be Indian.

Must-write keywords

constituent authority; M.N. Roy; Congress demand; adult franchise; August Offer; Cripps proposals; Cabinet Mission.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: the demand shifted authorship from Westminster to Indians. Evidence: Roy (1934), Congress (1935), Nehru (1938), August Offer (1940) and Cabinet Mission (1946). Analysis: each stage moved from idea to acceptance to institutional design. Qualification: the 1946 scheme did not reproduce Nehru's desired direct adult-franchise election.

Chronology

Date	Event
1934	M.N. Roy first put forward the idea
1935	Congress officially demanded a Constituent Assembly
1938	Nehru linked it to adult franchise and freedom from outside interference
1940	August Offer accepted the principle
1942	Cripps proposals; League sought two assemblies
1946	Cabinet Mission supplied the operative scheme

Evidence matrix

Stage	Institutional movement	Precision
M.N. Roy	Constitution made by Indians through a constituent body	Credit the proposal to Roy; do not call it a Congress proposal in 1934
Congress demand	Nationalist ownership of constitution-making	Official demand in 1935; Nehru's adult-franchise formulation came in 1938
British response	Rejection moved to acceptance in principle and then a scheme	August Offer was acceptance in principle, not the creation of the Assembly
Cabinet Mission	One Assembly under a negotiated federal scheme	It rejected the League's demand for two constituent assemblies

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] M.N. Roy, a pioneer of the communist movement in India, first put forward the idea of a Constituent Assembly in 1934. Source precision matters: he proposed the institutional idea; the Congress did not originate it.
- [FACT] The Indian National Congress first officially demanded a Constituent Assembly in 1935. In 1938, Jawaharlal Nehru stated that free India's Constitution should be framed without outside interference by an Assembly elected on adult franchise.
- [FACT] The August Offer of 1940 accepted the constitution-making principle. The Cripps proposals of 1942 envisaged post-war constitution-making, but the Muslim League sought two constituent assemblies.
- [FACT] The Cabinet Mission of 1946 rejected two assemblies and supplied the scheme under which the Indian Constituent Assembly was constituted.
- [ANALYSIS] The demand changed the source of constitutional authority: from a statute enacted for India by Westminster to a constitution reasoned and adopted in India.
- [LIMIT] Topic 01 owns the colonial Acts. This package uses only the endpoint bridge: the 1935 Act supplied inherited administrative material, but not the democratic source of the Constitution.

Prelims trap

Do not credit the 1934 proposal to Congress or describe the August Offer as the Assembly's constituting instrument.

Mains use

Use the chronology to introduce legitimacy as an evolving source-of-authority question.

Mini recap

Roy -> Congress -> Nehru -> August Offer -> Cripps -> Cabinet Mission.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - CABINET MISSION DESIGN AND ALLOCATION LOGIC

Visual first

PEOPLE (restricted electorate) -> PROVINCIAL ASSEMBLIES -> community PR-STV -> CA\nPRINCELY RULERS -> nominees

Caption: The Cabinet Mission designed a 389-seat, federal, indirectly elected and partly nominated Assembly rather than a directly elected sovereign convention.

Concept

The Cabinet Mission scheme was the institutional rulebook for allocating and selecting members of the Constituent Assembly.

Answer-grabbing line

The Assembly's founding design combined population, community assurance and territorial representation, but it carried the democratic limits of the colonial electoral order.

Must-write keywords

389; 296 British India; 93 princely states; one seat per million; community allocation; PR-STV; indirect election; nomination.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: representation was mediated rather than direct. Evidence: provincial community members in legislative assemblies voted by PR-STV, while princely rulers nominated representatives. Analysis: the scheme enabled negotiated inclusion without universal suffrage. Qualification: the four Chief Commissioners' seats and the precise state process should not be flattened into one identical election method.

Chronology

Date	Event
May 1946	Cabinet Mission statement and scheme
July-August 1946	Elections for British Indian seats
November 1946	Assembly constituted under the scheme

Evidence matrix

Component	Planned seats	Selection
Governors' provinces	292	Community members of provincial assemblies elected representatives by PR-STV
Chief Commissioners' provinces	4	One each under the scheme
Princely states	93	Representatives nominated by rulers
Total	389	296 British India plus 93 princely states

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] Planned strength was 389: 292 from eleven Governors' provinces, 4 from Chief Commissioners' provinces and 93 from princely states.
- [FACT] Allocation was broadly one seat per million population. Provincial seats were divided among Muslim, Sikh and General categories in proportion to their population.
- [FACT] Within a province, members of each community in the provincial legislative assembly elected that community's representatives by proportional representation through the single transferable vote.

- [FACT] Provincial assembly members themselves rested on the limited franchise of the period. Therefore the Constituent Assembly was indirectly elected, not elected by universal adult suffrage.
- [FACT] Princely-state representatives were to be nominated by the rulers. The Assembly was consequently partly elected and partly nominated.
- [LIMIT] Source caution: the Cabinet Mission statement contemplated settling the precise method of princely-state representation through consultation; standard UPSC texts describe the representatives who joined as nominated by rulers. Do not imply a popular election in the states.
- [LIMIT] Do not say every one of the 296 British Indian seats was filled through an identical direct popular ballot. The selection chain ran through provincial legislatures, and the four Chief Commissioners' province seats formed a distinct component.
- [ANALYSIS] The scheme tried to combine population, community assurance and territorial representation; this enhanced negotiated inclusion but entrenched categories inherited from late-colonial politics.

Prelims trap

PR-STV operated among provincial legislators; it did not mean the people directly elected the Assembly.

Mains use

Begin representativeness answers with the actual selection chain before offering a verdict.

Mini recap

389 = 296 British India + 93 states; indirect plus partly nominated.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - ELECTIONS, COMPOSITION CHANGE AND METRIC DISCIPLINE

Visual first

389 planned -> 296-seat election frame (208/73/15) -> 207 present officially -> 299 after Partition
-> 284 signatories

Caption: No single Assembly number proves representativeness: planned strength, elected-seat results, first-day attendance, post-Partition strength and signatories have different denominators.

Concept

Composition analysis distinguishes the Assembly's legal strength, political distribution, attendance and final signatories at particular dates.

Answer-grabbing line

The Assembly was Congress-dominated and electorally constrained, yet its social range and later deliberative output cannot be reduced to one headline figure.

Must-write keywords

208 Congress; 73 League; 15 others; 207 official first-session presence; 299 post-Partition; 284 signatories; source variance.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: Congress predominance was real. Evidence: 208 of the 296 British Indian seats, alongside League boycott and the official 207-person first-session register. Analysis: this shaped bargaining power and attendance. Qualification: an older local textbook prints 211, while 299 and 284 refer to later strength and signatures.

Chronology

Date	Event
July-August 1946	Congress 208, League 73, others 15 in elections for 296 seats
9 Dec 1946	First meeting; official register records 207 present amid League boycott
After Partition	Strength re-fixed at 299: 229 provinces plus 70 states
24 Jan 1950	284 members signed the Constitution

Evidence matrix

Metric	Verified figure	Meaning
Original planned strength	389	Design ceiling under Cabinet Mission
British India allocation/election frame	296	292 Governors' provinces plus 4 Chief Commissioners' provinces
Post-Partition strength	299	229 provincial plus 70 princely-state seats
First-meeting presence	207 in the official register; an older local textbook prints 211	Source-qualified attendance, not membership strength
Signatories on 24 Jan 1950	284	Actual signatures, not post-Partition sanctioned strength

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] In the 1946 elections for 296 British Indian seats, Congress won 208, the Muslim League 73, and smaller groups and independents 15. The 93 princely-state seats were initially unfilled because the states stayed away.
- [FACT] The Muslim League boycotted the first meeting; 207 members are listed in the official first-session register on 9 December 1946.
- [FACT] Partition reduced the strength from 389 to 299, consisting of 229 provincial and 70 princely-state seats.
- [FACT] On 24 January 1950, 284 members appended their signatures. Signing occurred after adoption, and 284 must not be presented as the Assembly's post-Partition strength.
- [ANALYSIS] Congress dominance was arithmetically real. Yet Congress functioned as a broad coalition, and the Assembly also included non-Congress experts and diverse social voices.
- [LIMIT] A single number cannot answer 'how representative?' Use selection method, social range, political dominance, boycott and post-Partition change together.

Prelims trap

Do not write 284 as membership strength or 389 as first-day attendance; disclose the 207/211 source variance.

Mains use

Use a denominator table to evaluate political dominance without erasing social and ideological diversity.

Mini recap

208/73/15 election result; 207 official opening presence; 299 strength; 284 signatories.

SESSION 4 - FOUNDATION - FIRST SITTING, PRESIDING OFFICERS AND SECRETARIAT

Visual first

SINHA opens -> PRASAD presides | RAU advises -> MUKERJEE drafts | MAVLANKAR chairs legislative business

Caption: The Assembly's authority depended on differentiated offices: presiding, advisory, secretarial, drafting and legislative roles were not interchangeable.

Concept

Institutional office mapping identifies who presided, advised, administered and technically drafted at each stage.

Answer-grabbing line

A leader-only narrative misses the administrative chain that converted constitutional choices into an authoritative legal text.

Must-write keywords

Sachchidananda Sinha; Rajendra Prasad; H.C. Mookherjee; V.T. Krishnamachari; B.N. Rau; H.V.R. Iyengar; S.N. Mukerjee.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: office differentiation strengthened institutional capacity. Evidence: Sinha opened the Assembly, Prasad presided permanently, Rau advised, Iyengar ran the secretariat and Mukerjee handled technical drafting. Analysis: specialised roles separated procedure from legal preparation. Qualification: Mavlankar's later legislative chairmanship belongs to the Assembly's second capacity.

Chronology

Date	Event
9 Dec 1946	First sitting; Sachchidananda Sinha temporary President
11 Dec 1946	Rajendra Prasad elected permanent President
13 Dec 1946	Objectives Resolution introduced
22 Jan 1947	Objectives Resolution adopted

Evidence matrix

Role	Person	Function
Temporary President	Dr Sachchidananda Sinha	Presided at the opening under the French oldest-member practice
President	Dr Rajendra Prasad	Presided over constituent deliberations
Vice-Presidents	H.C. Mookherjee and V.T. Krishnamachari	Assisted the presidency
Constitutional Adviser	B.N. Rau	Research, comparative advice and initial constitutional-adviser draft
Secretary	H.V.R. Iyengar	Assembly secretariat
Chief Draftsman	S.N. Mukerjee	Technical legislative drafting

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] The first meeting was held on 9 December 1946. Sachchidananda Sinha, the oldest member, became temporary President following the French practice.
- [FACT] Rajendra Prasad was elected permanent President. H.C. Mookherjee and V.T. Krishnamachari served as Vice-Presidents.
- [FACT] B.N. Rau was Constitutional Adviser; H.V.R. Iyengar was Secretary; S.N. Mukerjee was Chief Draftsman.
- [ANALYSIS] Secretariat and drafting expertise converted political settlements into administrable text. A leader-only narrative misses this institutional production chain.

- [LIMIT] The Assembly had distinct constituent and legislative capacities after independence. Rajendra Prasad presided in the constituent role; G.V. Mavlankar presided when it functioned as the Dominion legislature.

Prelims trap

Temporary President, permanent President, Constitutional Adviser and Drafting Committee chair are four different answers.

Mains use

Use the office-function table to correct hero-centric or role-confusion questions.

Mini recap

Sinha temporary; Prasad permanent; Rau adviser; Mukerjee draftsman.

SESSION 5 - FOUNDATION - OBJECTIVES RESOLUTION TO PREAMBLE

Visual first

NATIONALIST VALUES -> OBJECTIVES RESOLUTION -> COMMITTEE CHOICES -> MODIFIED PREAMBLE

Caption: The Objectives Resolution was the normative bridge between nationalist self-government and the Constitution's final identity.

Concept

The Objectives Resolution stated the values and purposes that guided later institutional drafting.

Answer-grabbing line

By fixing popular authority, justice, equality, freedom, safeguards and world peace before clause drafting, the Resolution constrained constitutional means by constitutional ends.

Must-write keywords

13 December 1946; 22 January 1947; Nehru; popular sovereignty; justice; equality; freedom; safeguards; Preamble.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: values preceded machinery. Evidence: Nehru moved the Resolution on 13 December 1946 and the Assembly adopted it on 22 January 1947. Analysis: committees could bargain over institutions within a declared normative horizon. Qualification: its modified form, not its verbatim text, became the Preamble.

Chronology

Date	Event
13 Dec 1946	Nehru moved the Objectives Resolution
22 Jan 1947	Assembly adopted it unanimously
26 Nov 1949	Modified values enacted in the Preamble

Evidence matrix

Resolution idea	Constitutional destination	Caution
Independent sovereign republic	Preamble's sovereign democratic republic	Socialist and secular were added only in 1976
Power from the people	We, the People	The Assembly itself was indirectly elected
Justice, equality and freedoms	Preamble plus Parts III and IV	Specific rights are owned by later topics
Minority/backward/tribal safeguards	Rights and special constitutional protections	Do not reduce safeguards to separate electorates
World peace	Preamble/Directive Principle ethos	Not a justiciable foreign-policy command

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] Nehru moved the Objectives Resolution on 13 December 1946; it was adopted on 22 January 1947.
- [FACT] It declared the resolve for an independent sovereign republic, a Union, authority derived from the people, justice, equality and freedoms, safeguards for minorities and backward and tribal areas, territorial integrity and contribution to world peace.
- [FACT] Its modified form became the Preamble.
- [ANALYSIS] The Resolution worked as a normative constraint: committees could disagree about machinery, but they drafted within a publicly stated value framework.
- [LIMIT] It did not contain the final 1949 wording. 'Socialist' and 'secular' were inserted into the Preamble by the 42nd Amendment in 1976.

Prelims trap

Nehru moved the Resolution; Ambedkar did not, and the words 'socialist' and 'secular' were later additions to the Preamble.

Mains use

Use Resolution -> committee choices -> modified Preamble as a value-to-text chain.

Mini recap

Moved 13 Dec; adopted 22 Jan; modified into the Preamble.

SESSION 6 - CORE - INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT 1947: SOVEREIGNTY AND DUAL INSTITUTIONAL ROLES

Visual first

DEC 1946: British-framed origin -> 15 AUG 1947: sovereign CA + Dominion legislature -> 1950 constitutional order

Caption: The Indian Independence Act 1947 changed the Assembly's legal capacity without retroactively changing its restricted electoral origin.

Concept

The sovereignty upgrade was the removal of external British legal control and the addition of Dominion legislative authority.

Answer-grabbing line

The Assembly's sovereignty must be periodised: British-framed at origin, legally autonomous after independence, and still imperfect in representative composition.

Must-write keywords

Indian Independence Act 1947; sovereign body; Dominion legislature; Rajendra Prasad; G.V. Mavlankar; 299.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: 1947 transformed authority. Evidence: the Independence Act empowered the Assembly to frame any Constitution and alter British enactments while it also legislated for the Dominion. Analysis: legal sovereignty answered one criticism. Qualification: indirect election and princely nomination remained democratic limitations.

Role map

Capacity after independence	Presiding officer	Function
Constituent body	Dr Rajendra Prasad	Framed, debated and adopted the Constitution
Dominion legislature	G.V. Mavlankar	Performed ordinary legislative business

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] The Act ended external constitutional subordination to Westminster and enabled the Assembly to repeal British enactments for India.
- [FACT] Partition led members from areas allocated to Pakistan to withdraw; sanctioned strength became 299, comprising 229 provincial and 70 princely-state seats.
- [ANALYSIS] Sovereignty criticism must be periodised: the Cabinet Mission shaped the Assembly's origin, while the 1947 Act removed the continuing British legal veto.
- [LIMIT] Sovereignty did not cure every democratic deficit. Indirect election, restricted franchise and princely nomination remain relevant to representativeness.

Prelims trap

Do not say the Assembly was equally sovereign on 9 December 1946 and after 15 August 1947.

Mains use

Separate the sovereignty question from the representativeness question and answer each with its own timeline.

Mini recap

Origin under Cabinet Mission; sovereignty and dual role after Independence.

SESSION 7 - CORE - COMMITTEE ARCHITECTURE AND DISTRIBUTED AUTHORSHIP

Visual first

SUBJECT COMMITTEES -> SUBCOMMITTEES -> DRAFTING COMMITTEE -> PLENARY AMENDMENT/VOTE

Caption: Committee government made a vast constitutional agenda negotiable by separating principle-setting, specialised scrutiny, drafting and plenary authorisation.

Concept

Distributed authorship means that no chairperson or committee alone possessed the whole constitution-making function.

Answer-grabbing line

India's Constitution was institutionally authored through a committee-to-adviser-to-drafting-to-plenary chain, not written by a solitary figure.

Must-write keywords

Union Powers; Union Constitution; Provincial Constitution; Advisory Committee; Drafting Committee; Rules; Steering; subcommittees.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: specialisation improved deliberation. Evidence: Nehru's Union committees, Patel's Provincial and Advisory committees, Prasad's procedural committees and specialist rights/minority/tribal subcommittees. Analysis: smaller bodies framed manageable choices for plenary decision. Qualification: committee reports acquired authority only through Assembly consideration.

Chronology

Date	Event
1946-47	Major subject committees and subcommittees worked
29 Aug 1947	Drafting Committee appointed
1948-49	Draft examined through readings and amendments

Evidence matrix

Committee	Chair	Core scope
Union Powers Committee	Jawaharlal Nehru	Distribution and character of Union powers
Union Constitution Committee	Jawaharlal Nehru	Structure of the Union constitution
Provincial Constitution Committee	Vallabhbhai Patel	Provincial constitutional structure
Advisory Committee	Vallabhbhai Patel	Fundamental rights, minorities, tribal and excluded areas
Fundamental Rights Sub-Committee	J.B. Kripalani	Rights recommendations
Minorities Sub-Committee	H.C. Mookherjee	Minority safeguards
North-East Frontier (Assam) Tribal/Excluded Areas Sub-Committee	Gopinath Bardoloi	Assam tribal and excluded areas
Excluded and Partially Excluded Areas Sub-Committee (other than Assam)	A.V. Thakkar	Tribal/excluded areas outside Assam
Drafting Committee	B.R. Ambedkar	Convert decisions and reports into a coherent draft

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] Major committees included Union Powers and Union Constitution under Nehru; Provincial Constitution and the Advisory Committee under Patel; Drafting under Ambedkar; Rules of Procedure and Steering under Rajendra Prasad; and the States Committee under Nehru.
- [FACT] The Advisory Committee was supported by specialised subcommittees on fundamental rights, minorities, and tribal/excluded areas.
- [ANALYSIS] Committee architecture separated agenda formation, negotiated settlement, legal drafting and plenary authorisation.
- [ANALYSIS] This is why 'Ambedkar wrote the Constitution' is useful shorthand but bad institutional history: reports, adviser work, drafting, amendments and final Assembly votes were separate stages.
- [LIMIT] Chairmanship does not imply sole authorship; committee recommendations remained subject to the Assembly.

Prelims trap

Patel chaired the parent Advisory Committee; Kripalani, Mookherjee, Bardoloi and Thakkar chaired distinct subcommittees.

Mains use

A committee map turns a descriptive answer into an institutional-process explanation.

Mini recap

Committees specialised; the Assembly retained final authority.

SESSION 8 - CORE - B.N. RAU, DRAFTING COMMITTEE AND ASSEMBLY: ROLE FLOW

Visual first

RAU: advise -> DRAFTING COMMITTEE: integrate -> AMBEDKAR: pilot -> ASSEMBLY: authorise

Caption: Rau advised, the Drafting Committee integrated, Ambedkar piloted and the Assembly authorised.

Concept

The drafting pipeline separated comparative research, legal formulation, political defence and final constituent decision.

Answer-grabbing line

Ambedkar's exceptional leadership is best defended by locating it accurately within, not outside, a distributed process.

Must-write keywords

B.N. Rau; Constitutional Adviser; 29 August 1947; seven-member Drafting Committee; B.R. Ambedkar; S.N. Mukerjee; Assembly.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: constitutional production had successive roles. Evidence: Rau's adviser material preceded the Committee's February 1948 Draft; Ambedkar chaired and defended the Draft; Mukerjee supplied technical language; the Assembly amended it. Analysis: role separation improved coherence and legitimacy. Qualification: neither collective authorship nor specialist contribution diminishes Ambedkar's central responsibility.

Chronology

Date	Event
Oct 1947	Constitutional Adviser prepared an initial draft
29 Aug 1947	Drafting Committee appointed
Feb 1948	Draft Constitution published
Oct 1948	Revised draft published
4 Nov 1948	Ambedkar introduced the Draft in the Assembly

Evidence matrix

Actor	Contribution	Boundary
B.N. Rau	Comparative research, advice, initial adviser draft	Did not chair the Drafting Committee or adopt the Constitution
Drafting Committee	Scrutinised material, reconciled decisions and framed the Draft Constitution	Could not replace the plenary Assembly's authority
B.R. Ambedkar	Chaired Drafting Committee; piloted and defended the Draft	Central role, but not solitary authorship
S.N. Mukerjee	Technical drafting and language	Not the constitutional decision-maker
Constituent Assembly	Debated, amended, adopted and later signed	Final institutional author

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] B.N. Rau's adviser draft preceded the Drafting Committee's published Draft Constitution.
- [FACT] The seven-member Drafting Committee was appointed on 29 August 1947 under B.R. Ambedkar.
- [FACT] Original members were Ambedkar, N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar, Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar, K.M. Munshi, Mohammad Saadulla, B.L. Mitter and D.P. Khaitan. N. Madhava Rau replaced Mitter; T.T. Krishnamachari replaced Khaitan.
- [FACT] The Drafting Committee sat for 141 days. A draft appeared in February 1948 and a revised draft in October 1948.
- [ANALYSIS] Rau widened the menu of constitutional techniques; the Committee converted choices into a coherent instrument; the Assembly supplied democratic-deliberative authority.
- [LIMIT] Avoid both errors: erasing Ambedkar's exceptional leadership and reducing a collective process to one person.

Prelims trap

B.N. Rau was not a Drafting Committee member, and the Drafting Committee did not itself adopt the Constitution.

Mains use

Use the verbs advised -> integrated -> piloted -> amended/adopted.

Mini recap

Research is not drafting; drafting is not adoption.

SESSION 9 - CORE - DRAFTING STAGES, READINGS, ADOPTION, SIGNING AND COMMENCEMENT

Visual first

FEB 1948 DRAFT -> OCT 1948 REVISION -> THREE READINGS -> 26 NOV ADOPT -> 24 JAN SIGN -> 26 JAN COMMENCE

Caption: The final Constitution emerged through public drafts and three readings, followed by separate acts of adoption, signing and commencement.

Concept

Constitutional enactment is a staged process in which publication, debate, amendment, passage, signature and legal commencement perform different functions.

Answer-grabbing line

Articles 393-395 make chronology legally decisive: the Constitution was adopted before it was signed and generally commenced.

Must-write keywords

February 1948 Draft; October 1948 revised Draft; three readings; 26 November 1949; 24 January 1950; 26 January 1950; Articles 393-395.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: adoption and commencement were not simultaneous. Evidence: adoption on 26 November, signatures on 24 January and general commencement under Article 394 on 26 January. Analysis: staged commencement enabled transitional institutions to operate. Qualification: named provisions, not the whole Constitution, commenced immediately.

Chronology

Date	Event
4 Nov 1948	First reading/general discussion began
15 Nov 1948-17 Oct 1949	Second reading: clause-by-clause consideration
14-26 Nov 1949	Third reading and adoption
24 Jan 1950	Members signed
26 Jan 1950	Remaining provisions commenced; India became a republic

Evidence matrix

Event	Date	Legal meaning
Adoption/enactment	26 Nov 1949	Assembly adopted the Constitution; specified provisions commenced at once
Signing	24 Jan 1950	284 members appended signatures
General commencement	26 Jan 1950	Remaining provisions commenced under Article 394
Repeal transition	26 Jan 1950	Article 395 repealed the 1935 and 1947 Acts, subject to its text
Original output	26 Nov 1949	Preamble, 395 Articles, 8 Schedules

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] Committee reports and Rau's adviser draft preceded the Drafting Committee's Draft Constitution. The public draft and comments fed further revision.

- [FACT] Ambedkar introduced the Draft on 4 November 1948. The second reading considered clauses from 15 November 1948 to 17 October 1949; the third reading ran in November 1949.
- [FACT] The Constitution was adopted on 26 November 1949, signed on 24 January 1950, and generally commenced on 26 January 1950.
- [FACT] Article 394 brought Articles 5-9, 60, 324, 366, 367, 379, 380, 388, 391-393 into force at once and the remaining provisions on 26 January 1950.
- [FACT] Article 393 gives the short title. Article 395 repealed the Indian Independence Act 1947 and Government of India Act 1935 with its amending/supplementing enactments. The Abolition of Privy Council Jurisdiction Act 1949 continued.
- [FACT] The original adopted Constitution had a Preamble, 395 Articles and 8 Schedules.
- [LIMIT] Do not say the Constitution was adopted on Republic Day or signed on 26 November.

Prelims trap

Article 393 is title, 394 commencement and 395 repeal; signing is not governed by substituting one of these dates.

Mains use

Use a date-function table and quote the Article 394 split rather than saying 'enforced in 1950' vaguely.

Mini recap

Adopted -> signed -> generally commenced.

SESSION 10 - CORE - OTHER FUNCTIONS, SYMBOLS, CONSTITUTIONAL CRAFT AND PROVISIONAL PARLIAMENT

Visual first

FRAME + LEGISLATE + ADOPT SYMBOLS + ELECT PRESIDENT -> PROVISIONAL PARLIAMENT -> ELECTED PARLIAMENT

Caption: The Assembly also acted as a national transition institution, adopting symbols, settling Commonwealth membership and continuing as provisional Parliament.

Concept

Other functions were institutionally separate decisions taken by the Assembly alongside constitution-making and Dominion legislation.

Answer-grabbing line

The Assembly did not disappear after adoption: it completed symbolic and presidential acts and then sustained parliamentary continuity until the elected Parliament assembled.

Must-write keywords

National Flag; Commonwealth; National Anthem; National Song; first President; provisional Parliament; elephant seal; calligraphy.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: the Assembly managed both founding and transition. Evidence: Flag (22 July 1947), Commonwealth membership (May 1949), anthem/song and first-President election (24 January 1950), followed by provisional Parliament. Analysis: these acts supplied institutional continuity and national symbolism. Qualification: they occurred on different dates and were not all constitutional provisions.

Other functions and dates

Function	Date / status	Precision
Adopted the National Flag	22 July 1947	Separate from Constitution adoption
Ratified continued Commonwealth membership	May 1949	Did not preserve Dominion status after 26 January 1950
Adopted the National Anthem and National Song	24 January 1950	Same sitting at which members signed
Elected Rajendra Prasad first President	24 January 1950	Office began with the Republic
Continued as provisional Parliament	26 January 1950 to 1952	Continued until the first elected Parliament assembled

Constitutional study, symbol, calligraphy and art

- [FACT] The Assembly studied constitutional experience from about sixty countries; comparative study informed selection and adaptation rather than mechanical copying.
- [FACT] The Preamble was enacted after the operative provisions so that it reflected the Constitution as finally settled.
- [FACT] The general commencement date honoured Purna Swaraj (complete self-rule) Day, observed on 26 January 1930 after the Lahore declaration.
- [FACT] Its seal or symbol was the elephant.
- [FACT] Prem Behari Narain Raizada calligraphed the English text in a flowing italic hand.
- [FACT] Nandalal Bose led the Shantiniketan artwork; Beohar Rammanohar Sinha illuminated the Preamble page.
- [FACT] The authoritative Hindi text was constitutionally provided later through the 58th Amendment, 1987.
- [FACT] The Government of India designated 26 November as Samvidhan Divas (Constitution Day) in 2015 to mark the adoption date.
- [LIMIT] These facts are Prelims support. They should not displace institutional analysis in a Mains answer.

Prelims trap

Constitution Day, Flag adoption, Anthem adoption and constitutional commencement are four separate chronological anchors.

Mains use

Use these functions to show that constitution-making also required orderly transfer and symbolic state formation.

Mini recap

Assembly framed, legislated, adopted symbols and bridged to elected Parliament.

SESSION 11 - CORE - MAJOR DEBATES AND OWNER-TOPIC CROSS-LINKS

Visual first

TENSION -> CONSTITUTIONAL CHOICE -> BENEFIT -> COST/LIMIT -> LATER DOCTRINAL OWNER

Caption: Constitutional choices were settlements between competing risks rather than abstract imports of ideal models.

Concept

A constitutional debate is best analysed as a tension, chosen mechanism, benefit, cost and later doctrinal owner.

Answer-grabbing line

Rights, federalism, executive responsibility and minority citizenship reveal a founding method of balancing liberty, unity, stability and social reform.

Must-write keywords

rights; public order; federalism; strong Union; parliamentary responsibility; DPSP; minority safeguards; common citizenship.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: the Assembly chose institutions under conflicting pressures. Evidence: rights plus restrictions, federal division plus a strong Union, parliamentary responsibility, and cultural safeguards without separate electorates. Analysis: each settlement traded one institutional risk against another. Qualification: detailed doctrine belongs to later Polity topics.

Chronology

Date	Event
1946-49	Committee negotiation and plenary debate
1949	Final settlements embedded in constitutional text
1950 onward	Courts, Parliament and amendments developed the choices

Evidence matrix

Debate	Constitution-making tension	Owner topic
Federalism	Strong Union versus provincial autonomy after Partition	Federal System/Centre-State Relations
Executive	Stability versus legislative responsibility	Parliamentary System
Fundamental rights	Liberty versus public order and reform	Fundamental Rights
DPSP	Transformative goals versus non-justiciability	Directive Principles
Minorities	Group safeguards versus common citizenship	FR/Minorities/Special Provisions
Language	National coordination versus linguistic plurality	Official Language
Citizenship	Partition emergency versus inclusive membership	Citizenship
Judiciary	Rights protection versus democratic policy space	Supreme Court
Services/emergency/property	Continuity and state capacity versus liberty/social transformation	Public Services/Emergency/Property history

Teaching and analysis

- [ANALYSIS] Federal design hardened toward a strong Union under the pressures of Partition, integration and administrative continuity, while retaining a constitutionally divided field of authority.
- [ANALYSIS] The parliamentary system prioritised a responsible executive answerable to the legislature over a separately elected executive.

- [ANALYSIS] Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles formed a liberty-transformation pair: enforceable restraints plus programmatic social commitments.
- [ANALYSIS] Minority debates moved away from communal electorates while retaining cultural, religious and equality protections.
- [ANALYSIS] Language, citizenship, judiciary, services, emergency powers and property each involved a compromise between unity/state capacity and plural freedom/social change.
- [LIMIT] This topic owns the making and debate logic, not full doctrine. Use one paragraph per debate and cross-link the later owner file.

Prelims trap

Consensus does not mean that federal, rights, language, property or minority choices were uncontested.

Mains use

Structure analytical paragraphs as tension -> institutional choice -> gain -> residual cost.

Mini recap

The founding settlement managed conflict; it did not abolish it.

SESSION 12 - CORE - BORROWED PROVISIONS AS ADAPTATION, NOT COPYING

Visual first

FOREIGN/COLONIAL TECHNIQUE + INDIAN PROBLEM + CHANGED FUNCTION = CONSTITUTIONAL ADAPTATION

Caption: Borrowing became constitutional originality when foreign and colonial devices were recombined under Indian popular sovereignty and social conditions.

Concept

Constitutional adaptation changes the authority, combination or function of a borrowed institution.

Answer-grabbing line

The relevant question is not whether India borrowed, but whether the borrowed technique was democratised, limited and integrated into a distinct constitutional whole.

Must-write keywords

comparative borrowing; parliamentary government; judicial review; Directive Principles; strong-centre federation; Government of India Act 1935; adaptation.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: comparative sources supplied techniques, not a ready-made Constitution. Evidence: parliamentary government under a written supreme text, enforceable rights alongside DPSP and 1935 machinery under republican accountability. Analysis: changed combinations produced new institutional effects. Qualification: colonial continuities and centralising risks remained substantial.

Chronology

Date	Event
Before 1947	1935 Act provided an administrative inheritance
1946-48	Rau and committees studied comparative models
1948-49	Assembly selected, modified and integrated devices

Evidence matrix

Source family	Often associated feature	Indian adaptation
United Kingdom	Parliamentary government, cabinet responsibility, rule-of-law traditions	Written and supreme Constitution; judicially enforceable rights
United States	Fundamental rights, judicial review/federal devices	Parliamentary rather than presidential executive; detailed limits and exceptions
Ireland	Directive Principles	Non-justiciable goals integrated with enforceable rights
Canada	Federation with a strong centre	Distinct Union-State lists and Indian emergency/integration context
Government of India Act 1935	Federal-administrative machinery, offices and lists	Democratised, rights-bound and placed under popular sovereignty

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] The framers studied foreign constitutions and inherited substantial administrative machinery from the Government of India Act 1935.
- [ANALYSIS] Borrowing is a technique, not a verdict. The correct test is whether an institution was selected, modified and integrated to meet Indian conditions.
- [ANALYSIS] Parliamentary government under a written supreme Constitution, enforceable rights alongside Directive Principles, and a federation with a strong Union are examples of synthesis rather than mechanical copying.
- [ANALYSIS] The Constitution combined continuity of institutions with rupture in legitimacy: colonial offices were retained where useful, but authority was relocated to the people and universal adult citizenship.
- [LIMIT] Avoid unverified one-feature-one-country lists. Many ideas have multiple lineages; use only securely established associations and explain adaptation.

Prelims trap

Avoid one-feature-one-country absolutism and the claim that administrative continuity proves constitutional copying.

Mains use

For every source named, add the Indian problem and the altered constitutional function.

Mini recap

Borrowed inputs; Indian hierarchy, combination and legitimacy.

SESSION 13 - SYNTHESIS - CONSENSUS, PARTY ORGANISATION AND NEGOTIATION

Visual first

COMMITTEE WORK <-> PARTY BARGAINING <-> INFORMAL NEGOTIATION -> PUBLIC PLENARY AUTHORISATION

Caption: Consensus was produced through committees, party forums, informal bargaining and public plenary justification.

Concept

Consensus in the Assembly meant a workable settlement after structured disagreement, not unanimity on every clause.

Answer-grabbing line

Congress dominance supplied coordination, but ideological breadth, committees and public amendment required bargaining rather than automatic assent.

Must-write keywords

committee bargaining; Congress umbrella; party forums; informal negotiation; plenary debate; amendments; procedural steering.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: institutional layering made disagreement governable. Evidence: committees narrowed issues, Congress forums coordinated positions and the plenary recorded reasons and amendments. Analysis: this combination reduced deadlock while preserving public authorisation. Qualification: unequal power and informal negotiation also created opacity and agenda-control concerns.

Chronology

Date	Event
Committee stage	Smaller groups gathered evidence and framed options
Congress/party forums	Differences were negotiated before and alongside plenary debate
Plenary stage	Public reasons, amendments and votes authorised the text

Evidence matrix

Mechanism	Contribution	Risk
Committees	Expertise and manageable bargaining	Technocratic insulation
Congress umbrella	Coalition discipline across ideological tendencies	Numerical dominance
Informal negotiation	Compromise before public deadlock	Opacity
Plenary debate	Public justification and amendment	Time and repetition
Presidential steering	Procedural continuity	Dependence on leadership

Teaching and analysis

- [ANALYSIS] Consensus was produced through repeated movement between committees, party forums, informal negotiation and plenary debate.
- [ANALYSIS] Congress dominance facilitated coordination, but its internal ideological breadth meant that agreement still required bargaining among socialists, Gandhians, liberals, conservatives and provincial interests.
- [ANALYSIS] Patel's committee and integration work, Nehru's Union/value agenda, Ambedkar's drafting leadership, Prasad's procedural stewardship and Rau's technical preparation were complementary roles.
- [ANALYSIS] Consensus did not erase dissent. It made disagreement governable by narrowing options, recording objections and accepting a final institutional settlement.
- [LIMIT] Do not romanticise: unequal social power, indirect election, the League boycott and princely nomination constrained the process.

Prelims trap

Numerical dominance is evidence of power, not proof that debate was either meaningless or perfectly equal.

Mains use

Explain the mechanism of consensus before praising its durability.

Mini recap

Consensus was organised bargaining plus final plenary authority.

SESSION 14 - SYNTHESIS - PEOPLE AND PLURAL VOICES WITHOUT HERO-ONLY REDUCTION

Visual first

IDENTITY + NAMED INTERVENTION + ISSUE + INSTITUTIONAL EFFECT -> SUBSTANTIVE REPRESENTATION

Caption: The Assembly's authorship becomes clearer when famous leaders are connected to women, minority, Dalit and tribal interventions on specific constitutional questions.

Concept

Plural participation is assessed through the issues members advanced, not merely through a list of identities present.

Answer-grabbing line

The strongest representativeness argument links named voices to equality, untouchability, minority citizenship, tribal autonomy and social reform while conceding unequal numbers.

Must-write keywords

Hansa Mehta; Dakshayani Velayudhan; Begum Aizaz Rasul; Rajkumari Amrit Kaur; Durgabai Deshmukh; Jaipal Singh Munda; minority citizenship.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: marginalised participants shaped substantive debate. Evidence: Mehta on equality, Velayudhan on caste and untouchability, Aizaz Rasul against separate electorates and Jaipal Singh Munda on Adivasi claims. Analysis: participation broadened the deliberative record. Qualification: named interventions do not erase structural under-representation.

Chronology

Date	Event
1946-50	Members intervened through committees and plenary debate
Post-Partition	Minority safeguards and common citizenship were renegotiated
1950	Universal adult franchise widened democratic membership beyond the Assembly's own electorate

Evidence matrix

Person/group	Verified institutional contribution	Analytical use
B.R. Ambedkar	Drafting Committee chair; piloted Draft	Legal coherence and social-democratic transformation
Jawaharlal Nehru	Objectives Resolution; Union committees	Value framework and Union design
Vallabhbhai Patel	Provincial/Advisory committees; states integration context	Federal settlement and minority/tribal channels
Rajendra Prasad	Assembly President; Rules/Steering leadership	Procedural legitimacy
B.N. Rau	Constitutional Adviser and initial draft	Comparative-technical preparation
Hansa Mehta	Equality and women's-status interventions	Formal equality and gendered citizenship
Dakshayani Velayudhan	Dalit woman member; opposed untouchability and stressed social transformation	Marginalised constitutional voice
Begum Aizaz Rasul	Muslim woman member; opposed separate electorates	Minority citizenship beyond communal electorates
Durgabai Deshmukh / Rajkumari Amrit Kaur	Social reform, language/welfare and rights concerns	Women as substantive participants, not symbols

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] Gandhi was not a member. His political and moral influence is not the same as institutional membership.
- [ANALYSIS] Ambedkar's role was exceptional because he chaired drafting, defended clauses and linked political democracy to social conditions; precision requires credit without solitary-authorship mythology.
- [ANALYSIS] Women members and marginalised voices intervened on equality, untouchability, minority representation, social reform, language and citizenship.
- [ANALYSIS] The Assembly's most radical representative act was prospective: it constitutionalised universal adult franchise, expanding political equality far beyond the restricted electorate that indirectly produced it.
- [LIMIT] Do not invent quotations or attribute every final clause to one speech. State verified participation and the issue advanced.

Prelims trap

Do not treat Gandhi as a member or women and minorities as merely ceremonial presences.

Mains use

Use two or three named interventions, each tied to an issue and analytical consequence.

Mini recap

Presence mattered through interventions; unequal representation still mattered.

SESSION 15 - SYNTHESIS - CRITICISM VERSUS EVIDENCE-LED REPLY

Visual first

CRITICISM -> CONCEDE FACTUAL KERNEL -> NAMED REPLY -> RESIDUAL LIMIT -> GRADED VERDICT

Caption: A defensible evaluation concedes each criticism's factual kernel, answers it with named institutional evidence and retains the residual limitation.

Concept

Criticism-reply analysis distinguishes what was true at origin, what changed over time and what remained unresolved.

Answer-grabbing line

The Assembly's legitimacy is strongest when defended without denying restricted franchise, Congress predominance or social imbalance.

Must-write keywords

not representative; not sovereign; Congress dominance; lawyer-politician; Hindu-dominated; time-consuming; qualified rebuttal.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: the 'not sovereign' objection was time-bound. Evidence: British design shaped 1946, while the Independence Act altered authority in 1947. Analysis: one criticism weakened over time. Qualification: the electoral and social criticisms did not disappear with legal sovereignty.

Chronology

Date	Event
1946	Indirect, limited-franchise and partly nominated origin
1947	Independence Act made the Assembly sovereign
1949-50	Adoption, signature and universal-franchise constitutional order

Evidence matrix

Criticism	Evidence-led reply	Qualification
Non-sovereign	Indian Independence Act 1947 made it fully sovereign	British plan shaped its origin
Non-representative	Social diversity, debate and future universal franchise	No direct adult-franchise election
Congress-dominated	Congress was a broad coalition and experts/dissent were included	208 of 296 electoral seats confirms dominance
Lawyer-heavy	Legal expertise produced a detailed workable text	Professional/social imbalance remained
Time-consuming	11 sessions, complex transition and extended clause scrutiny	Comparisons with shorter constitutions are context-sensitive
Borrowed	Foreign devices were adapted and integrated	Colonial/foreign continuities were substantial
Hindu-dominated	League boycott and Partition altered composition; minority channels remained	Post-Partition imbalance cannot be denied

Teaching and analysis

- [ANALYSIS] The strongest reply never denies the criticism's factual kernel. It states the defect, identifies the contextual constraint or institutional answer, and retains a qualification.
- [FACT] Sovereignty criticism changes across time: plausible at the British-created origin, substantially answered after the Indian Independence Act 1947.
- [ANALYSIS] Representativeness has electoral and deliberative dimensions. The Assembly was weak on direct electoral mandate but stronger on social range, reason-giving and the universal franchise it created.

- [ANALYSIS] Congress dominance aided settlement but also raises questions about agenda control. Lawyerly expertise aided drafting but could not substitute for social representation.
- [LIMIT] Do not use unverifiable rhetorical quotations from critics. The evidence is sufficient without decorative attribution.

Prelims trap

A rebuttal that denies every defect is less persuasive than a source-based, periodised and qualified defence.

Mains use

Use criticism -> conceded kernel -> evidence-led reply -> residual limit.

Mini recap

Concede, rebut, qualify; never romanticise.

SESSION 16 - SYNTHESIS - TIME, COST, OUTPUT AND TRANSITION DASHBOARD

Visual first

11 sessions | 165 sitting days | 114 Draft days | 141 Committee days | 7,635 proposed | 2,473 moved

Caption: Metrics illuminate deliberative scale only when every number retains its source and denominator.

Concept

A metric dashboard separates Assembly sessions and sitting days from Draft debate, Drafting Committee work, amendments, elapsed duration and historical cost.

Answer-grabbing line

The length of constitution-making can support a thoroughness argument only after the source variations and unlike denominators are disclosed.

Must-write keywords

11 sessions; 165 sitting days; 114 Draft-debate days; 141 Drafting Committee days; 7,635 amendments; 2,473 moved; Rs 64 lakh; source variance.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: the process was intensive. Evidence: Sansad records 165 sitting days and 114 on the Draft; the Constituent Assembly record gives 7,635 proposed and 2,473 moved; Laxmikanth records 141 Drafting Committee days.

Analysis: scrutiny helps answer the delay criticism. Qualification: elapsed duration differs by one day across official and textbook summaries, and cost is a historical nominal textbook figure.

Source-qualified evidence dashboard

Measure	Secure statement	Source discipline
Sessions	11	Sansad facts page and local Laxmikanth agree
Assembly sitting days	165	Sansad facts page
Draft Constitution consideration	114 days	Sansad facts page and local Laxmikanth agree
Drafting Committee sittings	141 days	Local Laxmikanth
Amendments	7,635 proposed; 2,473 moved	Constituent Assembly closing record/PIB; local OCR editions print 7,653, so the official record controls
Elapsed duration	2 years, 11 months, 17 days in Sansad's facts page; 18 days in local Laxmikanth	State the source rather than pretending the summaries are identical
Historical cost	About Rs 64 lakh	Standard textbook nominal figure; do not convert to current value without a method
Original output	Preamble, 395 Articles and 8 Schedules	Original adopted Constitution, not today's count

Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] The official Sansad facts page records eleven sessions covering 165 sitting days, of which 114 were spent considering the Draft Constitution.
- [FACT] The Drafting Committee's 141 sitting days are a different denominator from the Assembly's 165 days.
- [FACT] The official closing record reports 7,635 proposed amendments and 2,473 actually moved; the local OCR textbooks' 7,653 is treated as a print/OCR variance rather than silently repeated.
- [LIMIT] Elapsed-duration summaries differ by one day: Sansad states 2 years, 11 months and 17 days, while Laxmikanth states 18 days. Use a source label if the exact day count matters.
- [ANALYSIS] These figures support an argument about scrutiny and complexity, but numbers alone do not prove that every delay was necessary or every debate equally inclusive.

Prelims trap

Do not substitute one metric for another or present a disputed elapsed-day count without naming its source.

Mains use

Use two or three metrics as corroboration after, not instead of, institutional analysis.

Mini recap

11 sessions; 165 sitting days; 114 Draft days; 141 Committee days.

SESSION 17 - SYNTHESIS - SOCIAL REVOLUTION, CONTINUITY AND RUPTURE

Visual first

INHERITED MACHINERY -> CONSTITUTIONAL LIMITS + POPULAR SOVEREIGNTY -> DEMOCRATIC TRANSFORMATION

Caption: The founding settlement combined administrative continuity with a rupture in the source, accountability and social purpose of public power.

Concept

Continuity and rupture compare inherited state machinery with the new constitutional principles governing that machinery.

Answer-grabbing line

The Constitution retained governable institutions while replacing imperial authority with republican popular sovereignty, rights and universal franchise.

Must-write keywords

administrative continuity; popular sovereignty; universal adult franchise; Fundamental Rights; DPSP; judicial review; strong Union; social revolution.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: continuity made government possible on day one. Evidence: offices, services, lists and legal techniques drew from the 1935 framework. Analysis: institutional capacity survived. Qualification: rights, franchise and constitutional accountability transformed the authority and purpose of that machinery.

Chronology

Date	Event
Colonial endpoint	Administrative continuity from the 1935 framework
Constitution-making	Rights, franchise, federal and parliamentary redesign
26 Jan 1950	Republican popular sovereignty commenced

Evidence matrix

Dimension	Continuity	Rupture
Administration	Offices, services, lists and legal techniques	Accountability to a republican Constitution
State capacity	Strong executive and emergency instruments	Justiciable rights and judicial control
Territory	Inherited provinces and integration process	Union founded constitutionally, not imperially
Citizenship	Existing population and transition rules	Universal adult political equality
Social order	Many institutions and inequalities survived	Equality, abolition of untouchability, reform goals and DPSP

Teaching and analysis

- [ANALYSIS] Constitutional continuity made government possible on day one; constitutional rupture changed why power was legitimate and to whom it was answerable.
- [ANALYSIS] Granville Austin's social-revolution lens is useful as analysis: the Constitution joined national unity, democratic institutions and social reform.
- [ANALYSIS] Universal adult franchise, equality, rights and Directive Principles converted constitution-making into a project of political and social transformation.
- [ANALYSIS] Yet the Constitution worked through inherited bureaucracy, courts, federal lists and emergency techniques. Transformation was constitutional and gradual, not a total administrative reset.
- [LIMIT] Do not present continuity as colonial copying or rupture as immediate social equality. Both operated simultaneously.

Prelims trap

Continuity does not prove colonial legitimacy survived, and transformative promises did not instantly eliminate social inequality.

Mains use

Use a two-column continuity-versus-rupture matrix and end with 'controlled democratic transformation'.

Mini recap

Inherited machinery; transformed legitimacy and purpose.

SESSION 18 - SYNTHESIS - UPSC ANSWER SPINE AND CURRENT INSTITUTIONAL RELEVANCE

Visual first

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> MECHANISM -> QUALIFICATION -> VERDICT

Caption: A high-scoring answer converts chronology into an argument about authority, representation, process and constitutional output.

Concept

Answer architecture selects evidence according to the directive and mark load rather than reproducing the chapter chronologically.

Answer-grabbing line

The examiner rewards a graded verdict supported by exact dates, one institutional mechanism and a visible qualification.

Must-write keywords

directive; thesis; named evidence; institutional mechanism; qualification; graded verdict; PYQ route.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: evidence must answer the question rather than decorate it. Evidence: 389/299 for composition, 1947 for sovereignty, committee-role distinctions for process and Articles 393-395 for transition. Analysis: each fact proves a different proposition. Qualification: no direct Mains PYQ is invented when the audited ledger has none.

Chronology

Date	Event
Prelims	Identify dates, roles, selection method and metrics
10 marks	One claim, three evidence units, one qualification
15 marks	Process plus debate plus balanced verdict
20 marks	Origins, composition, mechanisms, criticism/reply and legacy

Evidence matrix

Demand	Answer spine	Evidence minimum
How representative?	Method -> composition -> inclusion -> defects -> verdict	389/299, indirect election, boycott, universal franchise
Who made it?	Rau -> committees -> Drafting Committee -> Assembly	Named roles and dates
Borrowed?	Source -> adaptation -> Indian problem -> limitation	Three secure examples
Why durable?	Values -> committee bargaining -> legal coherence -> legitimacy limits	Objectives Resolution, readings, criticism/reply
Current relevance	Design principles for plural bargaining and institutional restraint	No forced daily-news peg required

Teaching and analysis

- [ANALYSIS] Current relevance lies in method: public reasons, committee scrutiny, opposition channels, federal negotiation, rights constraints and clear transition rules.
- [ANALYSIS] Use the Assembly to evaluate present institutional design without claiming that every current controversy reproduces 1946-49.
- [ANALYSIS] Every Mains paragraph should follow claim -> named institutional evidence -> significance -> limitation/qualification.
- [LIMIT] No direct Mains PYQ on the making process was found in the locally audited GS-I/GS-II corpus used for this package. Cross-owned applications must not be relabelled as direct PYQs.
- [FACT] Direct locally routed Prelims demands are 2021 Q93, 2023 Q85, 2024 Q61 and 2026 Q55; official-key status differs by year and is stated in the workbook.

Prelims trap

Do not label original practice as a PYQ or cite a provisional/unavailable key as final.

Mains use

For 10/15/20 marks, scale the number of evidence units while preserving claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification.

Mini recap

Decode demand; select evidence; analyse mechanism; qualify verdict.

SESSION 19 - SYNTHESIS - CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY DEBATES: ORIGINAL INTENT, LIVING CONSTITUTION AND TEXTUAL SUPREMACY

Visual first

TEXT + STRUCTURE + BINDING DOCTRINE
Debates

^

persuasive historical aid: CA

Caption: Constituent Assembly Debates illuminate historical purpose but remain subordinate to enacted text, constitutional structure and binding precedent.

Concept

The debates are persuasive external interpretive material, not an independent source of binding constitutional law.

Answer-grabbing line

Indian constitutional interpretation is neither frozen original intent nor unbounded judicial updating: historical purpose informs, while text and doctrine control.

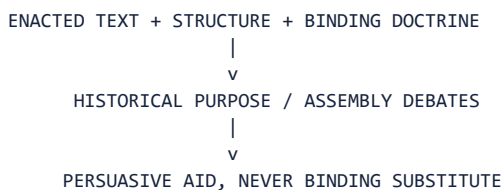
Must-write keywords

Constituent Assembly Debates; external aid; original intent; living Constitution; Article 21; Article 368; Maneka Gandhi; Kesavananda Bharati.

Paragraph-writing model: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link

Claim: founding debates may clarify purpose. Evidence: the due-process history supplies context for Article 21, while Maneka Gandhi later required fair, just and reasonable procedure. Analysis: doctrine can develop beyond a narrow historical choice. Qualification: development still requires textual, structural and precedential justification.

Interpretive hierarchy



Teaching and analysis

- [FACT] A member's speech is not law. The final enacted provision may reflect compromise, amendment or rejection of an individual proposal.
- [ANALYSIS] Original intent is most useful when it explains the constitutional problem addressed and the choice among competing formulations.
- [FACT] *Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India* (1978) illustrates doctrinal development: Article 21 came to require a procedure that is fair, just and reasonable despite the historical rejection of the American phrase due process.
- [FACT] *Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala* (1973) illustrates the living-identity tension: the basic-structure limitation is not express in Article 368, yet constitutional identity constrains destructive amendment.
- [LIMIT] These examples do not authorise free judicial rewriting. Text, structure, precedent and reasoned justification remain necessary.
- [LIMIT] Do not invent a framer's quotation or place a paraphrase in quotation marks.

Prelims trap

Never place an unverified framer paraphrase in quotation marks or treat one speech as the Assembly's binding intention.

Mains use

Use ambiguity -> debate/purpose -> later doctrine -> textual limit.

Mini recap

Persuasive history; binding text and doctrine.

This section contains exactly **32 original MCQs/drills** before the reproduced PYQ block. Questions 25-32 provide synthesis and remedial control.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Rotation and coverage

- Original objective count: **32**.
- Correct-option sequence: ABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCD.
- Formats include chronology, statement sets, assertion-reason, matching, role differentiation, source reconciliation, legal application and analytical inference.

Q1. Which sequence most accurately traces the political demand for an Indian constitution-making body?

A. M.N. Roy's proposal (1934) -> Congress demand (1935) -> Nehru's adult-franchise formulation (1938) -> August Offer (1940) B. Congress demand (1934) -> M.N. Roy's proposal (1935) -> Cripps Mission (1938) -> August Offer (1942) C. Nehru's adult-franchise formulation (1934) -> Congress demand (1938) -> Cabinet Mission (1940) -> Cripps Mission (1946) D. August Offer (1934) -> Congress demand (1935) -> M.N. Roy's proposal (1940) -> Cabinet Mission (1942)

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** This sequence separates the first individual proposal, the Congress's official demand, Nehru's democratic formulation and Britain's later acceptance in principle.
- **B - Incorrect.** Congress did not precede Roy, and the Cripps Mission belongs to 1942 rather than 1938.
- **C - Incorrect.** Nehru's adult-franchise statement came in 1938; the August Offer, not the Cabinet Mission, belongs to 1940.
- **D - Incorrect.** The August Offer did not occur in 1934, and Roy's proposal preceded rather than followed the Congress demand.

Examiner trap: Do not collapse 'first proposed', 'officially demanded', 'defined through adult franchise' and 'accepted in principle' into one event.

Q2. Jawaharlal Nehru's 1938 formulation added which democratic condition to the Congress demand?

A. Nomination of all members by provincial Governors B. Election of the Assembly on adult franchise without outside interference C. Two separate constituent assemblies for India and Pakistan D. A constitution enacted directly by the British Parliament

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** Governor nomination would have preserved colonial control and was not Nehru's democratic condition.
- **B - Correct.** Nehru linked a free Indian Constitution to a Constituent Assembly elected on adult franchise and free from external interference.
- **C - Incorrect.** The demand for two constituent assemblies was associated with the Muslim League's response to the Cripps proposals.
- **D - Incorrect.** Nehru's formulation rejected constitution-making by Westminster and asserted Indian constituent authority.

Examiner trap: The 1938 statement described the desired democratic basis; it did not describe the restricted indirect method actually used in 1946.

Q3. Which British initiative first accepted the principle that Indians would frame a new constitutional order?

A. Government of India Act 1935 B. Cripps proposals 1942 C. August Offer 1940 D. Indian Independence Act 1947

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** The 1935 Act supplied an imperial constitutional framework but did not concede an Indian constituent assembly.
- **B - Incorrect.** Cripps later proposed post-war constitution-making, but the principle had already been accepted in the August Offer.
- **C - Correct.** The August Offer marked acceptance in principle, although it did not itself constitute the Assembly.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Independence Act altered the legal sovereignty of an Assembly that had already begun work.

Examiner trap: Acceptance in principle in 1940 is different from an operative formation scheme in 1946 and sovereign authority in 1947.

Q4. Which comparison between the Cripps proposals and the Cabinet Mission is correct?

A. Both created two sovereign constituent assemblies immediately. B. Cripps rejected post-war constitution-making, while the Cabinet Mission restored British parliamentary drafting. C. The Cabinet Mission accepted the League's demand for two constituent assemblies. D. Cripps envisaged post-war constitution-making; the Cabinet Mission rejected two assemblies and supplied the operative scheme for one Assembly.

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** Neither initiative immediately created two sovereign assemblies; that reverses the Cabinet Mission's position.
- **B - Incorrect.** Cripps did contemplate constitution-making, and the Cabinet Mission proposed an Indian Assembly rather than Westminster drafting.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Cabinet Mission did not concede the League's two-assembly demand.
- **D - Correct.** This distinguishes a wartime proposal from the 1946 institutional scheme under which the Assembly was constituted.

Examiner trap: Questions often combine a true Cripps feature with a false Cabinet Mission consequence; test each mission separately.

Q5. Under the Cabinet Mission plan, the original strength of 389 was composed of:

A. 296 seats for British India and 93 for princely states B. 299 provincial seats and 90 princely-state seats C. 292 provincial seats and 97 princely-state seats D. 229 provincial seats and 160 princely-state seats

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The planned total was 389: 296 for British India, including 292 Governors' provinces and four Chief Commissioners' provinces, plus 93 princely-state seats.
- **B - Incorrect.** 299 was the reconstituted total after Partition, not the original provincial allocation.
- **C - Incorrect.** 292 counted Governors' province seats alone and omitted the four Chief Commissioners' province seats.
- **D - Incorrect.** 229 was the post-Partition provincial component; 160 was never the corresponding states allocation.

Examiner trap: Break 389 into 296 plus 93, and then break 296 into 292 plus four; do not mix original and post-Partition denominators.

Q6. How were representatives from a British Indian province chosen under the Cabinet Mission scheme?

A. By direct universal adult suffrage in territorial constituencies B. By members of the relevant community in the provincial legislature through proportional representation by single transferable vote C. By nomination of the provincial Governor from community panels D. By election in a joint sitting of the Central Legislative Assembly and Council of State

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** Universal adult suffrage was not the selection basis; provincial legislators themselves came from a restricted franchise.
- **B - Correct.** Community members in provincial legislative assemblies elected their allotted representatives by PR-STV, making the process indirect.
- **C - Incorrect.** Governor nomination was not the Cabinet Mission method for British Indian provincial seats.
- **D - Incorrect.** The central colonial legislature did not elect provincial Constituent Assembly representatives.

Examiner trap: PR-STV describes the vote among provincial legislators; it does not convert the process into a direct popular election.

Q7. Which statement handles the first-sitting attendance figure most responsibly?

A. All 389 planned members attended on 9 December 1946. B. The figure 211 is an uncontested official attendance total. C. The official first-session record reports 207 present, while an older local Laxmikanth edition prints 211; the source difference should be disclosed. D. No attendance figure can be used because the Muslim League boycotted the meeting.

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** 389 was the original planned strength, not attendance at the opening sitting.
- **B - Incorrect.** The older Sixth Revised Edition gives 211, but the official register-based account and newer courseware give 207.
- **C - Correct.** This formulation uses the official 207 figure while preserving the documented textbook variance instead of pretending unanimity.
- **D - Incorrect.** The boycott explains reduced attendance but does not prevent use of the official register count.

Examiner trap: Treat membership strength, possible participation and actual signatures in the attendance register as different measures.

Q8. After Partition, the reconstituted Assembly had:

A. 284 members: 229 provincial and 55 princely-state representatives B. 299 members: 296 provincial and three princely-state representatives C. 389 members because Partition did not alter the Assembly D. 299 members: 229 provincial and 70 princely-state representatives

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** 284 is the number commonly recorded as signatories, not the sanctioned post-Partition strength.
- **B - Incorrect.** The provincial component fell to 229; it did not remain 296.
- **C - Incorrect.** Members from territories assigned to Pakistan withdrew, so the original 389 did not survive Partition.
- **D - Correct.** The post-Partition total was 299, consisting of 229 provincial and 70 princely-state seats.

Examiner trap: Use 299 for reconstituted strength and 284 for signatories; the two figures answer different questions.

Q9. Which pairing of presiding officers is correct?

A. Temporary President: Sachchidananda Sinha; permanent President: Rajendra Prasad B. Temporary President: Rajendra Prasad; permanent President: G.V. Mavlankar C. Temporary President: B.N. Rau; permanent President: B.R. Ambedkar D. Temporary President: H.C. Mookherjee; permanent President: V.T. Krishnamachari

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** Sinha presided temporarily at the opening as the oldest member; Rajendra Prasad was elected permanent President on 11 December 1946.
- **B - Incorrect.** Rajendra Prasad was the permanent constituent presiding officer, while Mavlankar chaired legislative business after independence.
- **C - Incorrect.** Rau was Constitutional Adviser and Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee; neither held this pair of offices.
- **D - Incorrect.** Mookherjee and Krishnamachari served as Vice-Presidents, not temporary and permanent Presidents.

Examiner trap: The phrase 'Provisional President' in the 2024 PYQ refers to the opening temporary presiding officer, not the Dominion legislature's chair.

Q10. The Objectives Resolution was moved and adopted respectively on:

A. 9 December 1946 and 11 December 1946 B. 13 December 1946 and 22 January 1947 C. 22 January 1947 and 29 August 1947 D. 4 November 1948 and 26 November 1949

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** These dates concern the first sitting and Rajendra Prasad's election, not the Resolution.
- **B - Correct.** Nehru moved the Resolution on 13 December 1946, and the Assembly adopted it on 22 January 1947.
- **C - Incorrect.** 22 January was the adoption date, while 29 August was the Drafting Committee's appointment.
- **D - Incorrect.** These dates concern introduction of the Draft Constitution and final adoption.

Examiner trap: Keep three Nehru-related milestones separate: 1938 democratic formulation, 13 December 1946 motion and 22 January 1947 adoption.

Q11. Consider the Objectives Resolution: 1. Authority was to be derived from the people. 2. It promised safeguards for minorities and backward and tribal areas. 3. It contained the final words 'socialist' and 'secular'. Which are correct?

A. 1 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 2 only D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** Statement 1 is correct, but statement 2 is also part of the Resolution's safeguards commitment.
- **B - Incorrect.** Statement 2 is correct, but statement 3 imports words added to the Preamble by the 42nd Amendment in 1976.
- **C - Correct.** The Resolution grounded authority in the people and promised safeguards; it did not contain the later amended Preamble verbatim.
- **D - Incorrect.** Including statement 3 makes the combination incorrect because 'socialist' and 'secular' were not part of the 1947 Resolution's final constitutional wording.

Examiner trap: A value may be implicit in the founding debate without the exact later constitutional word appearing in the 1947 Resolution.

Q12. Assertion (A): The Assembly should not be described as fully sovereign from its first meeting. Reason (R): The Indian Independence Act 1947 later removed external legal subordination. Choose the correct answer.

A. Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A B. A is true, but R is false C. A is false, but R is true D. Both A and R are true, and R explains why sovereignty must be periodised

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** The reason directly explains the time-sensitive distinction, so denying the explanatory link is incorrect.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Independence Act did alter the Assembly's legal position, making the reason true.
- **C - Incorrect.** The assertion is also true because the Assembly's December 1946 origin remained within a British-devised framework.
- **D - Correct.** The Act marks the change from a constrained legal origin to a sovereign constituent and legislative body.

Examiner trap: Do not use a static label for sovereignty; specify whether the answer concerns December 1946 or the post-Independence Assembly.

Q13. After independence, which institutional pairing was correct?

A. Constituent business under Rajendra Prasad; Dominion-legislative business under G.V. Mavlankar B. Constituent business under Mavlankar; Dominion-legislative business under Ambedkar C. Both functions under Sachchidananda Sinha until 1950 D. Both functions under B.N. Rau because he was Constitutional Adviser

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The Assembly performed two roles on separate days: Rajendra Prasad chaired constitution-making, while Mavlankar chaired ordinary legislative business.
- **B - Incorrect.** Mavlankar did not chair the constituent function, and Ambedkar's Drafting Committee role was different from legislative presiding authority.
- **C - Incorrect.** Sinha's temporary presidency belonged to the first sitting in December 1946.
- **D - Incorrect.** Rau advised on constitutional design but did not preside over either institutional capacity.

Examiner trap: A single Assembly could exercise two capacities without having the same presiding officer in both.

Q14. Which committee-chair combination is correctly matched?

A. Union Powers Committee - Vallabhbhai Patel B. Provincial Constitution Committee - Vallabhbhai Patel C. States Committee - Rajendra Prasad D. Rules of Procedure Committee - B.R. Ambedkar

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** Nehru, not Patel, chaired the Union Powers Committee.
- **B - Correct.** Patel chaired the Provincial Constitution Committee as well as the parent Advisory Committee.
- **C - Incorrect.** Nehru chaired the States Committee for negotiations with princely states.
- **D - Incorrect.** Rajendra Prasad chaired the Rules of Procedure Committee; Ambedkar chaired Drafting.

Examiner trap: Memorise committee clusters by function: Nehru-Union/states, Patel-provinces/safeguards, Prasad-procedure, Ambedkar-drafting.

Q15. Which subcommittee pairing is correct?

A. Fundamental Rights - H.C. Mookherjee B. Minorities - J.B. Kripalani C. Assam tribal and excluded areas - Gopinath Bardoloi D. Excluded areas outside Assam - Jawaharlal Nehru

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** J.B. Kripalani chaired the Fundamental Rights Sub-Committee.
- **B - Incorrect.** H.C. Mookherjee chaired the Minorities Sub-Committee.
- **C - Correct.** Gopinath Bardoloi chaired the North-East Frontier/Assam tribal and excluded areas subcommittee.
- **D - Incorrect.** A.V. Thakkar, not Nehru, chaired the subcommittee for excluded and partially excluded areas outside Assam.

Examiner trap: Distinguish Patel's parent Advisory Committee from the four named specialist subcommittees beneath it.

Q16. Which sequence best represents distributed constitutional authorship?

A. Ambedkar alone -> final text -> ceremonial Assembly approval B. B.N. Rau -> British Parliament -> Indian referendum C. Provincial Governors -> Drafting Committee -> Privy Council D. Subject committees and Rau's advice -> Drafting Committee -> plenary debate, amendment and adoption

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** Ambedkar's leadership was exceptional, but committees, advisers and plenary votes prevent a solitary-authorship account.
- **B - Incorrect.** Rau advised the Indian process; Westminster and a referendum were not the adoption route.
- **C - Incorrect.** Provincial Governors and the Privy Council were not links in the Assembly's drafting-authorisation chain.
- **D - Correct.** This sequence attributes principle-setting, technical preparation, legal drafting and final authority to their proper institutions.

Examiner trap: Giving Ambedkar full credit for leadership does not require erasing Rau, committees, technical draftsmen or the Assembly's final vote.

Q17. Which statement about the Drafting Committee's membership is correct?

A. B.L. Mitter and D.P. Khaitan were original members; N. Madhava Rau and T.T. Krishnamachari later replaced them respectively B. B.N. Rau was one of the seven members and was replaced by S.N. Mukerjee C. Rajendra Prasad chaired the Committee while Ambedkar served as Constitutional Adviser D. The Committee began with nine members and was reduced to seven after Partition

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** Mitter resigned because of ill health and was replaced by N. Madhava Rau; Khaitan died and was replaced by T.T. Krishnamachari.
- **B - Incorrect.** B.N. Rau was Constitutional Adviser and S.N. Mukerjee Chief Draftsman; neither was paired as member and replacement.
- **C - Incorrect.** Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee, while Rau supplied constitutional advice.
- **D - Incorrect.** The standard committee was appointed with seven members; its size was not a Partition reduction from nine.

Examiner trap: Replacement questions test membership, not importance: Rau and Mukerjee were crucial but were not the two replacement members.

Q18. Which distinction between B.N. Rau and B.R. Ambedkar is most accurate?

A. Rau adopted the Constitution; Ambedkar merely calligraphed it B. Rau was Constitutional Adviser and prepared comparative/adviser material; Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee and piloted the Draft C. Rau chaired the Assembly; Ambedkar chaired the Dominion legislature D. Both performed identical offices at different dates

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** Adoption belonged to the Assembly, and Prem Behari Narain Raizada performed the English calligraphy.
- **B - Correct.** The distinction correctly separates advisory preparation from committee leadership and defence of the Draft in the Assembly.
- **C - Incorrect.** Rajendra Prasad chaired constituent business and G.V. Mavlankar legislative business.
- **D - Incorrect.** Their contributions were complementary but institutionally different, not the same office in succession.

Examiner trap: Use three verbs to prevent role confusion: Rau advised, Ambedkar chaired and piloted, the Assembly authorised.

Q19. Arrange the drafting milestones in chronological order: 1. Revised Draft published. 2. Drafting Committee appointed. 3. First public Draft published. 4. Ambedkar introduced the Draft in the Assembly.

A. 3-2-1-4 B. 2-1-3-4 C. 2-3-1-4 D. 1-2-4-3

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Committee had to be appointed before it could publish the first Draft.
- **B - Incorrect.** This places the revised Draft before the first public Draft.
- **C - Correct.** The correct order is 29 August 1947, February 1948, October 1948 and 4 November 1948.
- **D - Incorrect.** The October 1948 revision could not precede the Committee's appointment or follow Assembly introduction in this sequence.

Examiner trap: Do not confuse the adviser's preparatory draft with the Drafting Committee's February and October 1948 public texts.

Q20. Which sequence correctly distinguishes the final constitutional stages?

A. Signing 26 November 1949 -> adoption 24 January 1950 -> commencement 26 January 1950 B. Adoption and commencement 26 November 1949 -> signing 26 January 1950 C. Commencement 24 January 1950 -> adoption 26 January 1950 -> signing later D. Adoption 26 November 1949 -> signing 24 January 1950 -> general commencement 26 January 1950

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** The first two events are reversed: adoption preceded the 24 January signing.
- **B - Incorrect.** Most provisions did not commence on adoption day, and signing did not occur on Republic Day.
- **C - Incorrect.** 24 January was the signing/final-session date, not the date of general commencement.
- **D - Correct.** This sequence preserves three legally and historically distinct events.

Examiner trap: Any option that uses one date for adoption, signature and commencement is presumptively unsafe.

Q21. Article 393 of the Constitution deals with:

A. The short title, 'Constitution of India' B. The split commencement of constitutional provisions C. Repeal of the 1935 and 1947 Acts D. The authoritative Hindi text

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** Article 393 states the Constitution's short title.
- **B - Incorrect.** Split commencement is governed by Article 394.
- **C - Incorrect.** The specified repeal provision is Article 395.
- **D - Incorrect.** The authoritative Hindi text was later provided through Article 394A by the 58th Amendment.

Examiner trap: The final Part's article numbers are consecutive but not interchangeable: 393 title, 394 commencement, 395 repeals.

Q22. What is the controlling rule in Article 394?

A. Every provision commenced only on 26 January 1950 B. Article 394 and specified transitional provisions commenced at once; the remainder commenced on 26 January 1950 C. The Constitution commenced when 284 members signed it D. Commencement depended on a later presidential notification

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** Specified citizenship, election, transitional and final provisions operated from 26 November 1949.
- **B - Correct.** Article 394 creates the two-stage commencement and calls 26 January 1950 the commencement of the Constitution.
- **C - Incorrect.** Signing on 24 January was historically important but was not the legal trigger under Article 394.
- **D - Incorrect.** The constitutional text itself fixed the dates; no later notification was required for general commencement.

Examiner trap: Adoption brought named provisions into force immediately, not the whole Constitution and not none of it.

Q23. Article 395 expressly repealed:

A. Only the Indian Independence Act 1947 B. The Abolition of Privy Council Jurisdiction Act 1949 C. The Indian Independence Act 1947 and the Government of India Act 1935 with enactments amending or supplementing the latter D. Every colonial-era statute still in force

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** Article 395 also repealed the 1935 Act and its amending or supplementing enactments.
- **B - Incorrect.** The 1949 Privy Council jurisdiction statute was expressly not swept away by this repeal account.
- **C - Correct.** This follows the constitutional text and states the relationship to the 1935 Act precisely.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Constitution did not automatically repeal every pre-1950 statute; legal continuity operated subject to constitutional control.

Examiner trap: A sweeping 'all British laws were repealed' option ignores constitutional continuity and Article 372.

Q24. Which statement about immediate commencement on 26 November 1949 is correct?

A. Only the Preamble commenced; all Articles waited until Republic Day B. Only citizenship provisions commenced; election and transitional provisions waited C. All 395 Articles commenced because the Constitution had been adopted D. Article 394 itself and its named citizenship, election, transitional and final provisions commenced at once; the remainder waited until 26 January 1950

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** The immediate set was wider than the Preamble and included named Articles.
- **B - Incorrect.** Article 324 and several transitional/final provisions were also in the immediate set.
- **C - Incorrect.** Adoption did not produce general commencement of the entire constitutional text.

- **D - Correct.** The exact Article 394 list includes Articles 5-9, 60, 324, 366, 367, 379, 380, 388, 391-393, together with Article 394 itself.

Examiner trap: Count only if the question requires it; the safer rule is named immediate provisions versus the remaining provisions on 26 January.

Q25. Which event-date pair is correct?

A. National Flag adopted - 22 July 1947 B. Commonwealth membership ratified - 26 January 1950 C. National Anthem adopted - 26 November 1949 D. Rajendra Prasad elected first President - 15 August 1947

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The Assembly adopted the National Flag on 22 July 1947.
- **B - Incorrect.** It ratified continued Commonwealth membership in May 1949.
- **C - Incorrect.** The National Anthem and National Song decisions belong to 24 January 1950.
- **D - Incorrect.** Rajendra Prasad was elected the first President on 24 January 1950.

Examiner trap: The Assembly performed non-drafting functions on several dates; do not attach all national symbols to adoption day.

Q26. Which pairing correctly identifies constitutional craft?

A. B.N. Rau - English calligraphy B. Prem Behari Narain Raizada - English calligraphy C. S.N. Mukerjee - artistic decoration under Shantiniketan D. Nandalal Bose - Constitutional Adviser

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** Rau supplied constitutional advice and comparative preparation, not manuscript calligraphy.
- **B - Correct.** Prem Behari Narain Raizada hand-calligraphed the English original in an italic style.
- **C - Incorrect.** Mukerjee was the chief draftsman responsible for technical legislative language.
- **D - Incorrect.** Nandalal Bose led the Shantiniketan artistic team rather than advising on constitutional law.

Examiner trap: Separate legal authorship, technical drafting, calligraphy and visual decoration; each belongs to a different role.

Q27. Which metric statement is source-disciplined?

A. The Drafting Committee sat for 165 days and the Assembly for 141 days. B. All sources give exactly 2 years, 11 months and 18 days with no variation. C. Sansad records 11 sessions, 165 sitting days and 114 Draft-debate days; Laxmikanth records 141 Drafting Committee days, while elapsed-duration wording differs by one day across sources. D. The Rs 64 lakh cost is a current-price estimate certified by the Comptroller and Auditor General.

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** The figures are reversed: 165 is the Assembly sitting-day total and 141 is the Drafting Committee figure.
- **B - Incorrect.** Sansad's facts page states seventeen days, while the local standard textbook states eighteen days.
- **C - Correct.** This answer preserves each denominator and explicitly discloses the one-day source variation.
- **D - Incorrect.** Rs 64 lakh is a commonly recorded historical nominal textbook figure, not a modern CAG-certified valuation.

Examiner trap: Never merge sessions, Assembly sitting days, Draft-debate days, Drafting Committee days and elapsed calendar duration.

Q28. Which formulation best answers the charge that the Constitution was merely borrowed?

A. Foreign sources make the Constitution legally invalid. B. Every provision has one exclusive foreign source. C. The Government of India Act 1935 was copied without democratic transformation. D. The framers selected and recombined comparative devices under a written supreme Constitution, popular sovereignty and Indian social-federal conditions.

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** Comparative borrowing does not determine legal validity; constituent adoption and constitutional supremacy do.
- **B - Incorrect.** Many institutions have mixed lineages, so exclusive one-country attribution overstates certainty.
- **C - Incorrect.** Administrative continuity was substantial, but rights, franchise, accountability and the source of authority were transformed.
- **D - Correct.** This formulation tests adaptation and integration rather than treating foreign origin as self-proving imitation.

Examiner trap: A source list earns few marks unless each borrowed technique is linked to its altered Indian function.

Q29. Which inference best evaluates the Assembly's representativeness?

A. Its electoral mandate was limited, but social participation, committee deliberation and the universal franchise it created support qualified legitimacy B. Indirect election automatically made every Assembly decision illegitimate C. The presence of several communities proves perfect proportional representation D. Congress dominance is irrelevant because all votes were unanimous

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** This verdict concedes restricted indirect election while separately assessing social range, deliberation and prospective democratisation.
- **B - Incorrect.** A democratic deficit is significant, but automatic invalidity ignores post-1947 sovereignty and institutional deliberation.
- **C - Incorrect.** Presence is not the same as proportional equality, especially after boycott and Partition.
- **D - Incorrect.** Congress dominance was real, and consensus did not mean the absence of dissent or unequal influence.

Examiner trap: Representation must be tested on at least three axes: electoral mandate, social-political inclusion and deliberative output.

Q30. Which statement most accurately periodises the Assembly's sovereignty?

A. It remained legally subordinate to Westminster until 26 January 1950 B. Its British-framed origin constrained it in 1946, but the Indian Independence Act 1947 removed external legal subordination C. It was fully sovereign solely because Congress won 208 seats D. The Objectives Resolution itself repealed British constitutional statutes

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Independence Act changed the legal position before general constitutional commencement.
- **B - Correct.** This answer distinguishes the source of the Assembly's origin from its later power to frame and repeal without British veto.
- **C - Incorrect.** Party strength explains political dominance, not the legal source of constituent sovereignty.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Resolution stated values; it was not a repeal statute.

Examiner trap: Legal sovereignty and democratic representativeness are related but distinct tests; answer each with different evidence.

Q31. Which set of named contributions is correctly stated?

A. Hansa Mehta chaired Drafting; Dakshayani Velayudhan was Constitutional Adviser B. Begum Aizaz Rasul defended separate electorates; H.C. Mookherjee opposed minority safeguards C. Hansa Mehta advanced equality concerns, Dakshayani Velayudhan spoke from a Dalit woman's perspective, and Begum Aizaz Rasul opposed separate electorates D. Women members performed only ceremonial functions and did not intervene in substantive debates

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** Ambedkar chaired Drafting and B.N. Rau was Constitutional Adviser; the named women made different substantive interventions.
- **B - Incorrect.** Aizaz Rasul opposed separate electorates, while Mookherjee chaired the Minorities Sub-Committee.
- **C - Correct.** The three examples show that women and minority participation must be analysed through concrete interventions rather than symbolic presence alone.
- **D - Incorrect.** The record includes substantive interventions on equality, untouchability, minority citizenship, language, welfare and social reform.

Examiner trap: Do not answer inclusion by listing names only; connect each member to the issue on which she or he intervened.

Q32. How should Constituent Assembly Debates be used in constitutional interpretation?

A. As binding law that can override enacted wording B. As irrelevant political speeches that courts can never consult C. As a complete substitute for later precedent and structural interpretation D. As persuasive historical aids where purpose or ambiguity matters, subordinate to text, structure and binding doctrine

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** An individual speech cannot displace the provision finally enacted by the Assembly.
- **B - Incorrect.** Courts and scholars may consult the debates to illuminate purpose, especially where language is ambiguous.
- **C - Incorrect.** Later constitutional doctrine, including Article 21 and basic-structure jurisprudence, cannot be replaced by a frozen historical statement.
- **D - Correct.** This approach captures both the evidentiary value and the legal limit of founding-era debates.

Examiner trap: Avoid both extremes: framers' speeches are neither binding commands nor useless historical decoration.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Objective PYQ provenance and key discipline

- Reproduced objective PYQs: **4**, all directly routed to this topic.
- A letter is printed only for the locally held final official 2024 Set-A key.
- The 2021 and 2023 local official papers have no locally available final official key.
- The 2026 local key is explicitly provisional and is not promoted to final status.
- Direct owned Mains PYQs in the audited 2018-2025 GS-I/GS-II ledgers: **0**; none is invented.

PYQ 1 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q93

Question: What was the exact constitutional status of India on 26th January, 1950?

A. A Democratic Republic B. A Sovereign Democratic Republic C. A Sovereign Secular Democratic Republic D. Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept analysis: The Constitution generally commenced on 26 January 1950. The original Preamble used the words sovereign democratic republic; socialist and secular were inserted by the 42nd Amendment in 1976. Continued Commonwealth membership did not preserve Dominion status.

Elimination trap: Test the wording against the original 1950 Preamble, not today's amended Preamble.

Provenance/status: Exact official 2021 Set-A paper verified locally; final official key unavailable locally.

PYQ 2 - 2023 Prelims GS-I Q85

Question: Statement I: Constitution Day is celebrated on 26 November every year to promote constitutional values among citizens. Statement II: On 26 November 1949, the Constituent Assembly set up a Drafting Committee under B.R. Ambedkar to prepare a Draft Constitution.

A. Both statements are correct and Statement II explains Statement I B. Both statements are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I C. Statement I is correct but Statement II is incorrect D. Statement I is incorrect but Statement II is correct

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept analysis: Constitution Day is tied to adoption on 26 November 1949. The Drafting Committee was appointed earlier, on 29 August 1947. Evaluate each statement independently before testing the explanatory relationship.

Elimination trap: A correct commemoration date cannot rescue a false institutional event attached to the same date.

Provenance/status: Exact official 2023 paper verified locally; final official key unavailable locally.

PYQ 3 - 2024 Prelims GS-I Q61

Question: Who was the Provisional President of the Constituent Assembly before Dr Rajendra Prasad took over?

A. C. Rajagopalachari B. Dr B.R. Ambedkar C. T.T. Krishnamachari D. Dr Sachchidananda Sinha

Answer: D.

Official-key analysis: The locally held final official UPSC Set-A key records D. Sachchidananda Sinha, the oldest member, presided temporarily at the opening; Rajendra Prasad was elected permanent President.

Elimination trap: 'Provisional' here means temporary presiding officer, not provisional Parliament.

Provenance/status: Exact official 2024 Set-A paper and final official Set-A key verified locally.

PYQ 4 - 2026 Prelims GS-I Q55

Question, locally normalised: Consider the following statements with reference to the Constitution of India:

1. No Article specifies that it will officially be called the Constitution of India.
2. No Article specifies that the Indian Independence Act 1947 and Government of India Act 1935 stand repealed.
3. No Article mentions 26 January 1950 as the date of commencement.

A. There are two correct statements that include Statement 3 B. There is only one correct statement C. All three statements are correct D. There is no correct statement

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept analysis: Article 393 supplies the short title, Article 394 specifies the split commencement and Article 395 specifies the repeals. The repository key is provisional and conflicts with the straightforward constitutional-text reading, so no answer letter is promoted.

Elimination trap: Negative-statement questions require checking each proposition directly against the constitutional text before counting.

Provenance/status: Exact official 2026 Set-A paper verified locally; only a provisional local key is available.

Direct Mains PYQ audit

No direct owned Mains PYQ was found in the audited local GS-I/GS-II routing ledgers for 2018-2025. None is invented or imported from an adjacent owner.

Six original Mains questions with full model answers

Original Q1 - 10 marks / 150 words

Question: Assess the role of the Objectives Resolution in the making of the Constitution. Answer in 150 words.

Demand: Explain function and significance, not merely list its clauses.

Model answer: The Objectives Resolution was the Assembly's value framework before the constitutional machinery was finalised. Nehru introduced it on 13 December 1946 and the Assembly adopted it on 22 January 1947. It located authority in the people, envisaged an independent sovereign republic, and committed the future order to justice, equality, freedom, safeguards for minorities and tribal or backward areas, territorial integrity and world peace.

Its importance was institutional. Subject committees and the Drafting Committee could disagree about federal, executive or rights mechanisms, but they worked within a publicly declared normative horizon. Its modified form became the Preamble, giving continuity between nationalist constitutional aspiration and the enacted Constitution. The Resolution was not itself the final constitutional text: its language was modified, and later doctrine must be grounded in the Preamble and operative provisions. It was therefore the value bridge from political freedom to constitutional identity.

Why this earns marks: It gives dates, named value content, causal process significance and a precise limitation.

How to improve this answer: Add one explicit Preamble phrase and a one-line Resolution-to-Preamble comparison to make the value-to-text conversion visually undeniable.

Original Q2 - 10 marks / 150 words

Question: Differentiate the role of B.N. Rau from that of the Drafting Committee in Indian constitution-making. Answer in 150 words.

Demand: Compare functions and preserve the Assembly's final authority.

Model answer: B.N. Rau and the Drafting Committee occupied successive but distinct stages. As Constitutional Adviser, Rau organised comparative research, advised committees and prepared an initial adviser draft in 1947. His work widened the menu of constitutional techniques and converted committee materials into a preliminary legal architecture.

The seven-member Drafting Committee, appointed on 29 August 1947 under B.R. Ambedkar, scrutinised that material, reconciled committee decisions and prepared the Draft Constitution published in February 1948 and revised in October 1948. Ambedkar then introduced and defended the Draft in the Assembly. S.N. Mukerjee supplied technical legislative drafting.

Neither Rau nor the Committee possessed final constituent authority. The plenary Assembly debated clauses, moved amendments and adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949. Rau prepared and advised; the Committee legally integrated and piloted; the Assembly authorised. This differentiation credits Ambedkar's exceptional leadership without reducing a distributed process to solitary authorship.

Why this earns marks: It compares role, chronology, named evidence, institutional boundaries and final authorship.

How to improve this answer: Use a three-column Rau-Drafting Committee-Assembly table in rough work, then retain one action verb for each: advised, integrated/piloted, authorised.

Original Q3 - 15 marks / 250 words

Question: Critically examine the representative and sovereign character of the Constituent Assembly. Answer in 250 words.

Demand: Evaluate two distinct tests across time and end with a graded verdict.

Model answer: The Assembly's representative and sovereign character cannot be answered with one label. Under the Cabinet Mission scheme, its planned strength was 389: 296 British Indian and 93 princely-state seats. Provincial representatives were indirectly elected by community members of provincial assemblies through proportional representation by single transferable vote; princes nominated state representatives. The underlying provincial franchise was restricted. Congress won 208 of 296 seats, the Muslim League won 73, and the League boycotted the first sitting. These facts establish a real electoral and political deficit.

Representation nevertheless had a deliberative dimension. The Assembly included religious minorities, Scheduled Castes, tribal members and women; specialist committees created channels on rights, minorities and excluded areas. Congress itself contained competing ideological and provincial tendencies. The prospective democratic answer was stronger still: universal adult franchise made the polity far more representative than the founding body's electorate.

Sovereignty changed over time. The Cabinet Mission and British legal framework shaped the origin, so the criticism had force in December 1946. The Indian Independence Act 1947, however, removed external legal subordination, empowered the Assembly to frame any Constitution and repeal British statutes, and added legislative capacity.

The Assembly was therefore not fully representative by modern electoral standards and was not equally sovereign at every stage. Yet post-1947 legal sovereignty, plural deliberation and universal-franchise output gave it qualified founding legitimacy.

Why this earns marks: It separates the two directives, periodises sovereignty, concedes defects and links evidence to a balanced verdict.

How to improve this answer: Add the official 207-person first-session register figure, note the older textbook's 211 variance only if relevant, and keep 284 strictly for signatories.

Original Q4 - 15 marks / 250 words

Question: Explain how committee government strengthened the deliberative process of the Constituent Assembly. Answer in 250 words.

Demand: Show mechanism, evidence, benefit and limitation.

Model answer: Committee government converted a vast and conflict-ridden constitutional agenda into specialised, negotiable and draftable units. Nehru's Union Powers and Union Constitution Committees framed central architecture; Patel's Provincial Constitution and Advisory Committees linked federal design with rights, minority and tribal safeguards. The Kripalani, H.C. Mookherjee, Gopinath Bardoloi and A.V. Thakkar subcommittees deepened issue-specific scrutiny.

This architecture separated four functions. First, subject committees gathered evidence and narrowed choices. Second, B.N. Rau supplied comparative advice and an initial draft. Third, Ambedkar's Drafting Committee reconciled reports into coherent legal text. Fourth, the plenary Assembly publicly debated, amended and authorised that text. The movement between smaller committees, party forums, informal negotiation and plenary sessions reduced deadlock without eliminating dissent.

The mechanism strengthened deliberation in three ways: expertise improved precision; smaller forums made bargaining manageable; and plenary readings preserved public reasons and final authority. The cost was possible technocratic insulation and opacity in pre-plenary settlements, intensified by Congress dominance and unequal representation. Committee work was legitimate because it remained subordinate to the Assembly.

Thus, specialisation did not replace deliberation; it organised it. The durability of the final settlement arose from expert preparation joined to political negotiation and public constitutional authorisation.

Why this earns marks: It names committees, explains the production chain, analyses benefits and retains institutional limitations.

How to improve this answer: Name the Drafting Committee's 141 sitting days or the Assembly's 114 draft-debate days as one quantified proof that committee specialisation remained connected to plenary scrutiny.

Original Q5 - 20 marks / 250 words

Question: Indian constitution-making represented both continuity and rupture. Discuss. Answer in 250 words.

Demand: Analyse both sides through institutions, legitimacy and social purpose.

Model answer: Indian constitution-making was a controlled constitutional transformation: it retained machinery necessary for governability while replacing colonial legitimacy with republican popular sovereignty.

Continuity: Administrative offices, legislative lists, public services, courts and drafting techniques drew heavily on the Government of India Act 1935. A strong executive, emergency instruments and centralising devices reflected inherited state-capacity concerns intensified by Partition and integration. Staged commencement under Article 394 and repeal under Article 395 also show a legally managed transition rather than an institutional vacuum.

Rupture: The Objectives Resolution located authority in the people rather than Westminster. The Constitution created a sovereign democratic republic, parliamentary responsibility under a supreme written Constitution, enforceable Fundamental Rights, judicial review and Directive Principles. Universal adult franchise established equal political membership from the beginning, far beyond the restricted electorate that indirectly produced the Assembly. Equality and the abolition of untouchability converted political independence into a project of social transformation.

Synthesis: Borrowed and inherited devices changed function when placed under popular sovereignty, rights and electoral accountability. Federal lists no longer served imperial supervision alone; they structured a constitutional Union. Bureaucratic continuity enabled day-one administration, while democratic rupture changed to whom that administration was answerable.

The transformation was incomplete. Inherited institutions carried centralising and bureaucratic habits, and constitutional promises did not instantly erase social hierarchy. Yet a complete administrative reset would have endangered governability.

The founding achievement was therefore controlled rupture: enough continuity to preserve state capacity, but enough democratic and social transformation to change the source, limits and purposes of public power.

Why this earns marks: It uses constitutional provisions and institutional examples, explains altered function, qualifies transformation and answers both sides of the directive.

How to improve this answer: Pair one inherited device with its transformed constitutional purpose—for example, legislative lists under imperial control versus lists under popular sovereignty and judicially enforceable federalism.

Original Q6 - 20 marks / 250 words

Question: Evaluate the legitimacy of the Constituent Assembly as India's constitution-making body. Answer in 250 words.

Demand: Build a criterion-based evaluation rather than praise or rejection.

Model answer: The Assembly's legitimacy was neither a pure popular mandate nor a British gift. It was progressively built through legal sovereignty, plural deliberation and democratic constitutional output.

Origin deficit: The Cabinet Mission designed a 389-member body. Provincial representatives were indirectly elected through restricted-franchise provincial assemblies and princely rulers nominated their representatives. Congress won 208 of 296 electoral seats; the League boycott and Partition reduced plural participation. These facts weaken a claim of full electoral representativeness.

Sovereignty: The objection that the Assembly was legally subordinate had force at its first sitting. The Indian Independence Act 1947 then empowered it to frame any Constitution, repeal British statutes and legislate for the Dominion. Sovereignty must therefore be periodised.

Deliberative legitimacy: Major committees, Rau's advice, Drafting Committee integration and clause-by-clause plenary readings created reasoned institutional authority. Women, Scheduled Caste, tribal and minority members participated substantively, though not proportionately.

Democratic output: The Constitution located authority in the people, established universal adult franchise, rights, representative government and constitutional remedies. The Assembly thereby created a more democratic polity than the electoral system that created it.

Residual limits: Congress agenda control, lawyer-politician predominance, social imbalance, princely nomination and the League's absence cannot be erased by later success. Deliberation is not a substitute for direct election; it is an additional source of legitimacy under the constraints of 1946-49.

The Assembly was thus imperfect but not illegitimate. It earned qualified founding legitimacy by converting a constrained origin into a sovereign, deliberative and universally democratic constitutional order.

Why this earns marks: It evaluates through explicit criteria, uses named institutional evidence, concedes residual deficits and reaches a graded verdict.

How to improve this answer: Use a compact criterion table-origin, process, output, residual limits-and attach one exact figure or institution to each row before reaching the graded verdict.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

PRE-ASSEMBLY PREPARATION -> DEEPER COMPOSITION -> COMMITTEE MEMORY MAP
-> DRAFTING INTENSITY -> CRITIC ATTRIBUTIONS -> CONSTITUTIONAL CRAFT
-> LIVING-CONSTITUTION REFINEMENT

This enrichment follows the complete core and is not required for a competent basic answer.

01. Congress Experts Committee and pre-Assembly preparation

Visual first

8 JULY 1946 APPOINTMENT -> TWO SITTINGS -> PROCEDURE + COMMITTEES + OBJECTIVES MATERIAL

Answer-grabbing line

The Congress Experts Committee shows that the Assembly entered its first sitting with prior Indian constitutional preparation, not an empty institutional slate.

Must-write keywords

Congress Experts Committee; 8 July 1946; Nehru; constitutional preparation; Objectives Resolution.

Paragraph-writing model

Claim: preparation preceded the formal Assembly. Evidence: the Congress appointed the Nehru-chaired Experts Committee on 8 July 1946, and its work included procedure, committee design and material resembling the Objectives Resolution. Analysis: nationalist actors had already begun translating political claims into institutional choices.

Qualification: this party committee did not replace the later Constituent Assembly's authority.

- [FACT] Congress appointed an Experts Committee on 8 July 1946 under Jawaharlal Nehru to prepare constitutional material before the Assembly met.
- [FACT] Its membership included Asaf Ali, K.M. Munshi, N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar, K.T. Shah, D.R. Gadgil, Humayun Kabir and K. Santhanam; Krishna Kripalani served as convener.
- [ANALYSIS] This shows that formal Assembly committees did not begin from a blank slate; nationalist constitutional preparation preceded the first sitting.
- [LIMIT] Use this as enrichment. It should not displace the Cabinet Mission composition or Assembly committee map in a core answer.

Prelims trap

Do not confuse the Congress Experts Committee with the Assembly's Drafting Committee appointed on 29 August 1947.

Mains use

Use it as evidence of pre-Assembly constitutional preparation, never as the final author of the Constitution.

Mini recap

Party preparation preceded, but did not supersede, constituent deliberation.

02. Deeper composition and representation controls

Visual first

POPULATION ALLOCATION -> COMMUNITY CATEGORIES -> INDIRECT PR-STV
+--> PRINCELY NOMINATION

Answer-grabbing line

The Assembly widened social presence through negotiated categories while remaining electorally narrower than the universal citizenship it later created.

Must-write keywords

one seat per million; community allocation; restricted franchise; social presence; proportionality.

Paragraph-writing model

Claim: the scheme sought inclusion through structured allocation. Evidence: seats were broadly population-based and provincial places were divided among Muslim, Sikh and General categories. Analysis: this reassured organised communities within the available colonial electorate. Qualification: category presence did not guarantee proportional social power or direct popular authorisation.

- [FACT] The Cabinet Mission used an approximate one-seat-per-million rule and community allocation among Muslim, Sikh and General categories.
- [FACT] The 1946 electoral outcome was Congress 208, Muslim League 73 and others 15 for the 296-seat British Indian frame; the 93 princely-state seats were initially substantially unfilled.
- [ANALYSIS] Community-based allocation widened negotiated assurance but carried the categories of late-colonial electoral politics into the founding process.
- [LIMIT] Social presence was real but not equal or proportionate; do not convert a list of communities into proof of perfect representation.

Prelims trap

Community allocation within provincial seats was not the same institution as princely-state nomination.

Mains use

Deploy the distinction between descriptive presence, proportionality and electoral mandate.

Mini recap

Negotiated inclusion existed inside a restricted and indirect design.

03. Committee chair memory map and relevant subcommittees

Visual first

NEHRU 3 | PATEL 2 | PRASAD 2 | AMBEDKAR 1
-> specialist rights/minority/tribal subcommittees

Answer-grabbing line

Committee chairmanship mapped responsibility, while authorship remained distributed and subject to plenary approval.

Must-write keywords

eight major committees; parent Advisory Committee; subcommittees; chairmanship; plenary control.

Paragraph-writing model

Claim: committee design widened both expertise and participation. Evidence: Patel's parent Advisory Committee worked through subcommittees chaired by Kripalani, Mookherjee, Bardoloi and Thakkar. Analysis: specialised forums converted broad conflicts into reportable proposals. Qualification: a chair's influence was substantial but never equivalent to sole authorship.

Chair	Major responsibility cluster
Nehru	Union Powers, Union Constitution and States Committee
Vallabhbhai Patel	Provincial Constitution and parent Advisory Committee
Rajendra Prasad	Rules of Procedure and Steering; also institutional leadership in other procedural committees
B.R. Ambedkar	Drafting Committee
J.B. Kripalani	Fundamental Rights Sub-Committee
H.C. Mookherjee	Minorities Sub-Committee
Gopinath Bardoloi	Assam / North-East tribal and excluded areas
A.V. Thakkar	Excluded and partially excluded areas outside Assam

Trap: Chairmanship identifies responsibility, not sole authorship.

- [FACT] Among the eight major committees listed in the core map, Nehru chaired three, Patel two, Rajendra Prasad two and Ambedkar one. Always name the committee; do not inflate a major-committee count by mixing in other procedural committees.

Prelims trap

Do not add minor or ad hoc committees when answering a question explicitly limited to the standard eight major committees.

Mains use

Use the chair map to demonstrate division of constitutional labour.

Mini recap

Committee responsibility was differentiated; final authority remained collective.

04. Drafting intensity and comparative study

Visual first

ABOUT 60 CONSTITUTIONS -> 141 COMMITTEE DAYS -> 114 DRAFT-DEBATE DAYS
-> 7,635 PROPOSED / 2,473 MOVED

Answer-grabbing line

The scale of comparative study and amendment scrutiny explains duration more persuasively than the bare allegation of delay.

Must-write keywords

comparative study; 141 days; 114 days; 7,635 proposed; 2,473 moved; denominator discipline.

Paragraph-writing model

Claim: the process was intensive rather than merely slow. Evidence: roughly sixty constitutions were consulted, the Drafting Committee sat for 141 days and the Assembly considered the Draft for 114 days while 2,473 of 7,635 proposed amendments were moved. Analysis: multiple review stages enabled adaptation and correction.

Qualification: quantity alone does not prove equal participation or perfect drafting.

- [FACT] The Assembly studied constitutional experience from about sixty countries.
- [FACT] The Drafting Committee sat for 141 days; the Draft Constitution was debated for 114 days in the Assembly.
- [FACT] The commonly cited account records 7,635 amendments proposed and 2,473 moved or disposed.
- [ANALYSIS] Comparative breadth and amendment intensity explain duration better than an unsupported allegation of drift.
- [LIMIT] Keep denominators distinct: committee days, plenary debate days, proposed amendments and moved amendments are not interchangeable.

Prelims trap

The 141-day Drafting Committee figure and 114-day Assembly consideration figure refer to different bodies.

Mains use

Use one or two figures to support a process argument; do not substitute a statistic dump for analysis.

Mini recap

Comparative breadth plus amendment scrutiny explains the process's depth.

05. Critic attributions and evidentiary caution

Visual first

CRITICAL LABEL -> VERIFY ATTRIBUTION -> TEST FACTUAL KERNEL -> ANSWER WITH INSTITUTIONAL EVIDENCE

Answer-grabbing line

A criticism becomes analytically useful only after its factual kernel is separated from its rhetoric.

Must-write keywords

Drifting Committee; Congress dominance; lawyer-politician; Hindu-dominated charge; source caution.

Paragraph-writing model

Claim: criticism exposed real deficits but often overstated their consequence. Evidence: indirect election, Congress dominance and post-Partition imbalance support parts of the critique. Analysis: post-1947 sovereignty, committee pluralism and universal franchise answer-but do not erase-those deficits. Qualification: use verified attributions or paraphrase without quotation marks.

- [FACT] Critics attacked indirect election, British origin, Congress dominance, lawyer-politician predominance, Hindu dominance and the time taken.
- [FACT] Naziruddin Ahmed used the expression *Drifting Committee* in criticising delay; British political critics also emphasised post-Partition religious imbalance.

- [ANALYSIS] The response should rely on institutional evidence rather than rhetorical counter-quotation: 1947 sovereignty, committee scrutiny, diverse participation and universal-franchise output.
- [LIMIT] Do not reproduce an exact quotation unless its wording has been independently verified. A source-owned criticism may be paraphrased without quotation marks.

Prelims trap

Do not turn a critic's description into an official constitutional classification.

Mains use

Pair every criticism with a conceded fact, a rebuttal and a surviving limitation.

Mini recap

Evidence outranks rhetoric in criticism-and-defence answers.

06. Constitutional craft, authoritative text and labels

Visual first

LEGAL CONTENT -> TECHNICAL DRAFTING -> CALLIGRAPHY -> ART
+--> 58TH AMENDMENT / ARTICLE 394A

Answer-grabbing line

The Constitution's physical authorship and authoritative language must be separated from its legal and institutional authorship.

Must-write keywords

Prem Behari Narain Raizada; Nandalal Bose; Beohar Rammanohar Sinha; 58th Amendment; Article 394A.

Paragraph-writing model

Claim: constitutional craft involved distinct contributions. Evidence: Raizada calligraphed the English text, Nandalal Bose's team decorated the manuscript and Beohar Rammanohar Sinha illuminated the Preamble page. Analysis: these acts shaped the document's material form, not its legal authority. Qualification: the authoritative Hindi-text provision came later through the 58th Amendment and Article 394A.

- [FACT] Prem Behari Narain Raizada calligraphed the English text; Shantiniketan artists under Nandalal Bose decorated the manuscript; Beohar Rammanohar Sinha illuminated the Preamble page.
- [FACT] The 58th Amendment, 1987 constitutionally provided an authoritative Hindi text.
- [FACT] Textbooks commonly describe Ambedkar as the Father of the Constitution because of his Drafting Committee leadership and defence of the Draft.
- [LIMIT] Popular textbook labels for Ambedkar recognise his exceptional drafting leadership, but labels are not a substitute for the distributed-authorship chain.

Prelims trap

Calligrapher, artist, chief draftsman, Constitutional Adviser and Drafting Committee chair are five different roles.

Mains use

Use craft details sparingly to demonstrate distributed contribution, not as a substitute for institutional analysis.

Mini recap

Material creation, legal drafting and constituent authorship must remain distinct.

07. Living Constitution refinement

Visual first

AMBIGUOUS TEXT -> FOUNDING PURPOSE AS PERSUASIVE AID
-> TEXT + STRUCTURE + BINDING PRECEDENT CONTROL

Answer-grabbing line

Constituent Assembly Debates illuminate constitutional purpose, but the Constitution remains a living legal text governed by enacted language, structure and precedent.

Must-write keywords

original intent; external aid; living Constitution; Article 21; Article 368; binding doctrine.

Paragraph-writing model

Claim: founding intent is relevant but not controlling. Evidence: the due-process debate supplies Article 21 history, while *Maneka Gandhi* required fair, just and reasonable procedure; *Kesavananda Bharati* derived an implied basic-structure limit. Analysis: constitutional meaning can develop through text and structure. Qualification: living interpretation is not judicial freedom to disregard enacted language.

- [ANALYSIS] Strict originalism is difficult because a multi-member Assembly had plural intentions and the enacted wording often embodied compromise.
- [FACT] *Maneka Gandhi* demonstrates rights doctrine developing beyond the narrowest historical choice; *Kesavananda Bharati* demonstrates an implied identity limit on amendment.
- [LIMIT] A living Constitution is not an untethered Constitution. Text, structure, precedent and reasoned justification constrain development.

Prelims trap

One framer's speech does not override the text adopted by the Assembly.

Mains use

Use debates to illuminate purpose, then return to constitutional text and controlling doctrine.

Mini recap

Historical purpose persuades; enacted law controls.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

1. Origin and constitutional-authority timeline

- 1934: M.N. Roy first proposed a Constituent Assembly.
- 1935: Congress officially demanded it.
- 1938: Nehru linked the free Constitution to an adult-franchise Assembly without outside interference.
- 1940: August Offer accepted the principle.
- 1942: Cripps proposed post-war constitution-making; the League sought two Assemblies.
- 1946: Cabinet Mission rejected two Assemblies and provided the operative scheme.
- Answer line: the demand moved constitution-making from imperial prescription towards Indian constituent self-government.

2. Cabinet Mission composition and election

- Original plan: 389 = 296 British India + 93 princely states.
- British India: 292 Governors' provinces + four Chief Commissioners' provinces.
- Rough allocation: one seat per million.
- Provincial categories: Muslim, Sikh and General.
- Election: relevant community members in provincial legislatures, PR-STV.
- Princely-state representatives: nominated by rulers.
- Verdict: indirectly elected, partly nominated and based on a restricted underlying franchise.

3. Political composition and number discipline

- 1946 election frame: Congress 208, Muslim League 73, others 15.
- First sitting, 9 December 1946: official register/account records 207 present; an older local Laxmikanth edition prints 211.
- Post-Partition strength: 299 = 229 provincial + 70 princely-state seats.
- Signatories on 24 January 1950: 284.
- Never merge planned strength, attendance, sanctioned strength and signatures.

4. Officers, Resolution and sovereignty

- Temporary/provisional President: Sachchidananda Sinha; permanent President: Rajendra Prasad.
- Vice-Presidents: H.C. Mookherjee and V.T. Krishnamachari.
- Constitutional Adviser: B.N. Rau; Secretary: H.V.R. Iyengar; Chief Draftsman: S.N. Mukerjee.
- Objectives Resolution: Nehru moved it on 13 December 1946; adopted 22 January 1947; modified form became the Preamble.
- Indian Independence Act 1947: removed external legal subordination and added Dominion-legislative authority.
- Constituent business under Prasad; legislative business under G.V. Mavlankar.

5. Committee map and distributed authorship

- Nehru: Union Powers, Union Constitution and States Committees.
- Patel: Provincial Constitution and parent Advisory Committee.
- Prasad: Rules of Procedure and Steering Committees.
- Ambedkar: Drafting Committee.
- Subcommittees: Kripalani-Fundamental Rights; Mookherjee-Minorities; Bardoloi-Assam tribal/excluded areas; Thakkar-other excluded areas.
- Role chain: committees settle principles -> Rau supplies advice/adviser material -> Drafting Committee integrates -> Ambedkar pilots -> Assembly debates, amends and adopts.

6. Drafting Committee and readings

- Seven-member Drafting Committee appointed 29 August 1947.
- Original members: Ambedkar, N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar, Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar, K.M. Munshi, Mohammad Saadulla, B.L. Mitter and D.P. Khaitan.
- Replacements: N. Madhava Rau for Mitter; T.T. Krishnamachari for Khaitan.
- Public Draft: February 1948; revised Draft: October 1948.
- First reading from 4 November 1948; second reading 15 November 1948-17 October 1949; third reading 14-26 November 1949.

7. Adoption, signing, commencement and continuity

- Adopted: 26 November 1949.
- Signed: 24 January 1950.
- General commencement: 26 January 1950, chosen for the 1930 Purna Swaraj association.
- Article 393: short title.
- Article 394: itself and named provisions came into force at once; remaining provisions on 26 January 1950.
- Article 395: repealed the Indian Independence Act 1947 and Government of India Act 1935 with enactments amending or supplementing the latter.
- The Abolition of Privy Council Jurisdiction Act 1949 continued.
- Original adopted output: Preamble, 395 Articles and 8 Schedules; Preamble enacted last.

8. Functions, craft and source-qualified metrics

- National Flag: 22 July 1947; Commonwealth membership: May 1949.
- Anthem, Song and first-President election: 24 January 1950.
- Provisional Parliament: from 26 January 1950 until the elected Parliament assembled.
- Elephant seal; Prem Behari Narain Raizada calligraphy; Nandalal Bose's team art; Beohar Rammanohar Sinha Preamble illumination.
- 58th Amendment 1987 inserted Article 394A for the authoritative Hindi text.
- Sansad: 11 sessions, 165 sitting days, 114 Draft days, elapsed 2y 11m 17d.
- Laxmikanth: 141 Drafting Committee days, about Rs 64 lakh, elapsed 2y 11m 18d.
- Official closing record/PIB: 7,635 amendments proposed, 2,473 moved.

9. Representation, contributions and legitimacy

- Electoral deficit: indirect election, restricted provincial franchise and princely nomination.
- Political imbalance: Congress 208/296; League boycott and Partition changed composition.
- Deliberative strengths: committee specialisation, public Draft/comments, clause scrutiny and recorded dissent.
- Named voices: Hansa Mehta-equality; Dakshayani Velayudhan-caste/untouchability; Begum Aizaz Rasul-opposition to separate electorates; Jaipal Singh Munda-Adivasi claims.
- Prospective democratic compensation: universal adult franchise.
- Qualified verdict: not perfectly representative, but not merely a Congress or colonial body.

10. Criticism, borrowing and interpretive control

- Criticism formula: concede kernel -> named evidence -> rebuttal -> residual limit.
- Borrowing formula: source technique -> Indian problem -> changed function -> limitation.
- Continuity: services, offices, lists and legal technique; rupture: popular sovereignty, rights, review, republic and universal franchise.
- Constituent Assembly Debates are persuasive external aids; enacted text, structure and binding doctrine prevail.
- Do not invent framer quotations.

11. PYQ and answer-writing control

- Routed objective PYQs: 2021 Q93, 2023 Q85, 2024 Q61 and 2026 Q55.
- Only 2024 Q61 has a locally verified final official key: D, Sachchidananda Sinha.
- For 2021, 2023 and 2026 use exactly: **Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.**
- Direct owned Mains PYQs in audited 2018-2025 ledgers: zero.
- Paragraph formula: claim -> named evidence -> mechanism/analysis -> qualification/link.
- Final verdict: the Assembly converted a constrained electoral origin into a sovereign, deliberative and prospectively universal-democratic constitutional settlement.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

POLITY 02 - MAKING OF THE CONSTITUTION CONTINUOUS ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

PANEL 1/12 - ORIGIN OF CONSTITUENT AUTHORITY

1934 M.N. Roy proposal

- > 1935 Congress official demand
- > 1938 Nehru: adult-franchise Assembly without outside interference
- > 1940 August Offer: principle accepted
- > 1942 Cripps: post-war proposal; League sought two Assemblies
- > 1946 Cabinet Mission: operative single-Assembly scheme

TRAP: proposal, demand, acceptance and constitution are four different stages.

PANEL 2/12 - CABINET MISSION DESIGN AND REPRESENTATION

ORIGINAL PLAN: 389 = 296 British India + 93 princely states

296 = 292 Governors' provinces + 4 Chief Commissioners' provinces

roughly one seat per million population

provincial categories: Muslim | Sikh | General

election: respective community members in provincial legislatures, PR-STV

states: rulers' nominees

VERDICT: indirect election + partly nominated + restricted underlying franchise.

PANEL 3/12 - COMPOSITION, PARTITION AND SOURCE-DISCIPLINED NUMBERS

1946 election frame: Congress 208 | League 73 | others 15

9 Dec 1946 first meeting:

official register/current Sansad-linked account = 207 present

older local Laxmikanth Sixth Revised Edition = 211

-> disclose the source difference; do not merge it with strength

After Partition: 299 = 229 provincial + 70 princely-state seats

24 Jan 1950: 284 signatories

TRAP: 389 planned != 207 attendance != 299 strength != 284 signatures.

PANEL 4/12 - FIRST SITTING, OFFICES AND OBJECTIVES

Sachchidananda Sinha -> temporary/provisional President

Rajendra Prasad -> permanent President; constituent business

H.C. Mookherjee + V.T. Krishnamachari -> Vice-Presidents

B.N. Rau -> Constitutional Adviser

H.V.R. Iyengar -> Secretary

S.N. Mukerjee -> Chief Draftsman

13 Dec 1946 Nehru moves Objectives Resolution

22 Jan 1947 Assembly adopts it -> modified value form becomes Preamble.

PANEL 5/12 - SOVEREIGNTY CHANGES OVER TIME

DEC 1946: Cabinet Mission/British legal origin

-> 15 AUG 1947: Indian Independence Act removes external legal subordination

-> CA can frame any Constitution and alter/repeal British enactments

-> same Assembly also acts as Dominion legislature under G.V. Mavlankar

ANALYTICAL RULE: post-1947 sovereignty does not erase indirect-election limits.

PANEL 6/12 - COMMITTEE ARCHITECTURE AND DISTRIBUTED AUTHORSHIP

Nehru: Union Powers | Union Constitution | States

Patel: Provincial Constitution | parent Advisory Committee

Prasad: Rules of Procedure | Steering

Ambedkar: Drafting Committee

Subcommittees:

Kripalani-Fundamental Rights | Mookherjee-Minorities

Bardoloi-Assam tribal/excluded | Thakkar-other excluded areas

FLOW: committees -> Rau/adviser material -> Drafting Committee -> Assembly.

PANEL 7/12 - DRAFTING COMMITTEE AND ROLE BOUNDARIES

29 Aug 1947: seven-member Drafting Committee appointed

Original: Ambedkar, N.G. Ayyangar, Alladi K. Ayyar, K.M. Munshi,

Mohammad Saadulla, B.L. Mitter, D.P. Khaitan

Replacements: N. Madhava Rau for Mitter; T.T. Krishnamachari for Khaitan

B.N. Rau ADVISED | Ambedkar CHAIRED/PILOTED | Assembly AMENDED/ADOPTED

S.N. Mukerjee supplied technical drafting.

PANEL 8/12 - PUBLIC DRAFT, READINGS AND LEGAL TRANSITION

Feb 1948 public Draft -> eight months of comments -> Oct 1948 revised Draft

4 Nov 1948 first reading/general discussion

15 Nov 1948-17 Oct 1949 second reading/clause-by-clause

14-26 Nov 1949 third reading -> ADOPTION 26 Nov

SIGNING 24 Jan 1950 -> GENERAL COMMENCEMENT 26 Jan 1950

Art 393 short title | Art 394 split commencement | Art 395 repeals.

PANEL 9/12 - METRICS WITH DENOMINATORS AND SOURCES

Official Sansad facts: 11 sessions | 165 sitting days | 114 Draft days
Constituent Assembly/PIB record: 7,635 amendments proposed | 2,473 moved
Laxmikanth: Drafting Committee sat 141 days | cost about Rs 64 lakh
Elapsed duration:

Sansad facts page = 2 years, 11 months, 17 days

local Laxmikanth = about three years

RULE: name the source; never turn one denominator into another.

PANEL 10/12 - SYMBOLS, FUNCTIONS AND CONTINUITY

22 Jul 1947 National Flag | May 1949 Commonwealth membership
24 Jan 1950 Anthem + Song decisions + first-President election
26 Jan 1950 CA continues as provisional Parliament until elected Parliament
Elephant = Assembly seal | Prem Behari Narain Raizada = English calligraphy
Nandalal Bose team = art | Beohar Rammanohar Sinha = Preamble illumination
58th Amendment 1987 -> Article 394A authoritative Hindi text.

PANEL 11/12 - REPRESENTATION, CONTRIBUTION AND CRITICISM

DEFICITS: restricted indirect election | state nomination | Congress 208/296
League boycott/Partition | social imbalance | lawyer-politician weight
CONTRIBUTIONS: Hansa Mehta-equality | Dakshayani Velayudhan-caste/untouchability
Begum Aizaz Rasul-opposed separate electorates
Jaipal Singh Munda-Adivasi claims

REPLY: committee channels + reasoned debate + 1947 sovereignty + universal franchise

VERDICT: qualified legitimacy, not perfect representativeness.

PANEL 12/12 - EXAM AND INTERPRETIVE CONTROL

PYQs: 2021 Q93 | 2023 Q85 | 2024 Q61 | 2026 Q55

Only 2024 has a locally verified final official answer key.

For unavailable/provisional keys print:

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

CA Debates = persuasive external aid; enacted text/structure/doctrine prevail.

ANSWER SPINE:

claim -> named evidence -> mechanism/analysis -> qualification -> graded verdict.

FINAL LINE: A constrained founding body earned authority through sovereign,
deliberative and prospectively universal-democratic constitutional settlement.